



BRENDEN BURESH

DA Package Nomination

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GES Office of the CTO

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Executive Overview & General Information about Candidate

Brenden has spent his entire 26-year career at Cisco in individual contributor engineering roles. He joined Cisco in 1996 as part of the Enterprise team and continually progressed in different positions and teams until he attained Principal Architect designation in 2017 holding that role at the Central Area level until 2021. In 2022 Brenden was promoted to the GES Office of the CTO Team and has remained a Principal Architect until the present time in 2022.

Role/Title	Dates
PA GES Office of the CTO	2022 – Present
PA GES Central Area	2017 – 2021
Data Center TSA-2 GES Central Area	2014 – 2016
Data Center TSA-1 Midwest Operation	2011 – 2014
SE1V Commercial	2009 – 2011
SEIII Enterprise	2007 – 2009
SAN/Storage CSE / Data Center CSE	2005 – 2007
SEII and SEIII Enterprise	1996 - 2004

When Brenden joined Cisco, his background was large scale routing design. He quickly achieved his CCIE R&S (#2073) accreditation in 1996 and remained actively certified for 20 years before moving to lifetime emeritus status. In his first 15 years at Cisco, Brenden worked on projects and gained expertise in many areas, including large scale campus design, WAN, wireless, data center, server/compute, Internet/DMZ, and collaboration.

During his tenure as a TSA-2 and a Principal Architect, Brenden was part of the Central Area Pursuit team focused on data center and large-scale routing and switching. His subject matter expertise steadily expanded to include hybrid cloud, security, SD WAN, cloud edge, network programmability, and automation + orchestration, and he effectively became the first enterprise architect.

Brenden is highly focused on customer success and outcomes and has traveled extensively in support of customer engagements. He also has excellent communication skills and is equally comfortable at a whiteboard with a small audience or speaking at large public venues like CiscoLive. Brenden is frequently asked to support large revenue opportunities, complex design challenges, problem-oriented competitive situations, and scenarios where a multitude of BE and leadership resources need to be organized and aligned to a common objective.

Brenden leads by example and is consistently willing to expand into new technology areas. Brenden has shown a strong aptitude to drive cross team collaboration and cross BE architectures in support of customer solutions, and he has routinely become a trusted advisor at all levels of the customers he supports. Brenden maintains a broad spectrum of internal contacts across the BEs, CX Services, DA/PA community, and senior leadership, and leverages those relationships to solve customer business problems and drive internal product innovation and development.

This has resulted in repeated years of operation, area, and segment stretch performances and consistent individual recognition. At each stage of his progression through the organization, Brenden has consistently expanded his span of influence to the point that he now has a global impact at all levels of Cisco and in customer engagements. Brenden continues to drive horizon-1 objectives primarily supporting large strategic customer opportunities and has steadily increased his contributions to horizon-2 and horizon-3 internal efforts.

GLOBAL IMPACT SUMMARY

Since his promotion to Principal Architect, Brenden's influence has steadily developed from key contributions at the area and segment levels and expanded to strategic projects with global impact. He's engaged directly with customers across all Americas Enterprise geographies on projects ranging from large-scale routing and switching, data center and hybrid cloud, and SD WAN and cloud edge, to SASE and Zero Trust networking. He's actively

partnered with peers from the Federal segment to build joint business justifications for designs focused on multidomain orchestration, distributed CoLocation connectivity, full stack secure edge, and FedRAMP qualification.

Through his participation at CiscoLive in the US, EMEA, and APJC, Brenden has assisted hundreds of customers with a wide range of plans focused on data center, campus, WAN, hybrid cloud, security, analytics, and visibility. His efforts from the SASE SWAT team have directly affected Cisco's GTM strategy by building new sales campaigns, creating SASE content, producing SASE demos and labs, and driving product engineering and roadmap initiatives.

Brenden has led the building of worldwide SASE enablement training delivered across the Americas, EMEA, and APJC geographies to ~3,500 individuals and ~500 partner resources, with an average survey score of 4.76. He's had similar impact leading the Day-2 operations team for the EN&C Ideas Portal, where he's coordinated with the data center BE driving product strategy, roadmap direction, feature prioritization, and customer engagement model. Brenden has also made extraordinary investments to competitive efforts against VMware, Arista, and Zscaler, building and delivering blackbelt training, designing and presenting SEVT collateral, and recording live broadcast immersive competitive sessions.

SPAN OF INFLUENCE SUMMARY

Brenden has expanded his span of influence through an increased number of high-profile projects and a broader diversity of internal contacts throughout all levels of sales, product management, engineering, services, and marketing. He has worked on the largest and most strategic projects in the Central area and, equally importantly, covered customer opportunities spanning the East, West, South, and Premier areas. By continually expanding his expertise into more technology disciplines and focusing on enterprise architecture, he's become a highly trusted and well-known field resource across a broader group of BEs and extending into senior leadership levels.

Brenden is an ardent member of the PA/DA community, driving a multitude of key projects individually while also participating in a significant number of high-priority corporate initiatives. He's an original member of the SASE SWAT team responsible for driving Cisco's development plans for SASE platform architecture and working with the BEs to identify portfolio gaps, capture customer use cases, and prioritize roadmap commitments.

Brenden has also been an MDO SWAT team member from the start, collaborating with leadership and the BEs to generate a strategic business case for Cisco to invest in and develop a standardized multidomain orchestration platform to ease customer integration challenges and provide competitive differentiation. He was one of the first Performance IT leads within Cisco helping shape the strategic engagement practice of connecting with customers to create business ROI-driven architecture transformations. Additionally, Brenden was instrumental in pushing forward the Meraki GES strategy to broaden positioning of Cisco's flagship cloud management platform.

INDUSTRY IMPACT SUMMARY

Brenden has contributed in ways that have reached beyond Cisco to have broader industry impact. He has been a long-time contributor to CiscoLive in the US, EMEA, and APJC. As a presenter of technical seminars, breakouts, and DevNet sessions, Brenden has won Distinguished Speaker recognition in EMEA and APJC. Starting in 2018, Brenden expanded his CiscoLive role and became a session group manager (SGM) for the data center track for the US and EMEA. He also was on the team to create Cisco's first ever on-demand, hybrid, and combined global events.

Brenden also built a customer workshop series focused on industry transitions for Zero Trust networking, cloud edge design, and hybrid cloud architecture. The workshops are typically delivered over a half-day, a full day, or in a series of multiple events, and they have driven customer demand for more in-depth engagements and pushed competitors to provide comparable offers.

Brenden has also impacted the broader industry through internal development initiatives with Target, evolving SONiC/SAI open-source integration on Cisco hardware, and with Thomson Reuters, designing a full stack hybrid cloud utility platform. The open-source efforts have resulted in Cisco contributing software for broader industry

consumption in partnership with Microsoft. The development of the hybrid cloud utility platform has advanced Cisco's efforts to move to as-a-service delivery.

BUSINESS IMPACT SUMMARY

Brenden has devoted tremendous time and energy in support of **direct customer engagements** across all verticals, geographies, and technologies, which has provided tremendous business impact to Cisco. He has consistently been requested to lead and support the largest and most strategic opportunities and in the last 4 years has worked on deals with revenue totaling \$1.65B.

Date	Client	Business Impact Annualized	Business Impact Total
2018 – 2021	American Electric Power	FY18: \$27M, FY19: \$23M, FY20: \$15M, FY21: \$13M	Total Revenue - \$78M
2018 – Present	Anthem Healthcare	FY18: \$32M, FY19: \$55M, FY20: \$38M, FY21: \$69M	Total Revenue - \$194M
2018 – Present	Eli Lilly and Company	Potential Large-Scale SASE and Thousand Eyes Wins for \$25M in FY22	Potential Revenue - \$25M
2018 – Present	Exelon	End-to-End Cross Domain Win for \$118M in FY21	Total Revenue - \$118M
2018 – Present	Health Care Services Corporation	FY18: \$3M, FY19: \$20M, FY20: \$29M, FY21: \$14M	Total Revenue - \$66M
2018 – Present	Humana Healthcare	FY18: \$42M, FY19: \$17M, FY20: \$53M, FY21: \$37M	Total Revenue - \$149M
2018 – Present	Huntington Bank	FY18: \$26M, FY19: \$15M, FY20: \$33M, FY21: \$57M	Total Revenue - \$131M
2018 – 2021	Marriott International	FY18: \$19M, FY19: \$15M, FY20: \$6M, FY21: \$14M	Total Revenue - \$54M
2018 - Present	Mayo Clinic	FY18: \$11M, FY19: \$41M, FY20: \$13M, FY21: \$9M	Total Revenue - \$74M
2018 - Present	Medtronic	FY18: \$27M, FY19: \$16M, FY20: \$24M, FY21: \$30M	Total Revenue - \$97M
2018 – Present	Nationwide Insurance	FY18: \$7M, FY19: \$21M, FY20: \$3M, FY21: \$5M	Total Revenue - \$36M
2018 - Present	Progressive Insurance	FY18: \$21M, FY19: \$79M, FY20: \$38M, FY21: \$48M	Total Revenue \$186M
2018 - Present	UnitedHealth Group	FY18: \$86M, FY19: \$68M, FY20: \$48M, FY21: \$75M	Total Revenue - \$277M
2018 - Present	US Bank	FY18: \$42M, FY19: \$95M, FY20: \$35M, FY21: \$20M	Total Revenue - \$192M

Brenden's broad and deep technical skillset for enterprise architecture, covering topics like data center, hybrid cloud, campus, WAN, security, network programmability, and automation and orchestration, makes him ideal for building trusted advisor relationships across all customer leadership and technical ranks.

Brenden also has a strong business impact driving internal strategic initiatives and priorities on some of Cisco's biggest bets in terms of target addressable market (TAM). He has done this by leading SWAT team efforts, working directly with BEs on product development and service creation, partnering with CX services to generate offer programs, and building field enablement plans. This has influenced investment resources and funding, platform integrations, and guided Cisco's go-to-market plans.

Brenden's work driving internal initiatives and his **indirect customer engagements** have also contributed to the overall business impact he's had across Cisco. Efforts like the Meraki GES go-to-market strategy which resulted in \$30M in FY21 revenue and 300% Y-Y growth in GES Central impacted hundreds of customers. The SASE SWAT team

workstream and contributing to the SASE RFP response team are affecting hundreds of customers across the globe which will have sizeable future revenue implications. Brenden's contributions building the Performance IT practice, now evolved to Business Value Architecture (BVA), is utilized as the basis for building large customer cross domain opportunities which is again impacting hundreds of customers and the associated revenue. Finally, the MDO SWAT team initiative which is driving Platform Suite is one of Cisco's biggest bets for end-end cross domain architecture.

The indirect customer engagements have resulted in Brenden expanding his global impact as he engages with customers across all GES areas, Federal, Service Provider, Commercial, EMEA, and APJC. His influence is evidenced by the fact he meets and gets involved with customers through public events like CiscoLive, internal events such as customer advisory boards, partner events where he's been asked to participate, and internal recommendations from a wide variety of sources. Brenden's enterprise architecture focus across multiple technology disciplines, his background in a wide spectrum of industry verticals results, and his consultative approach makes him a highly sought-after resource. Some examples of recent engagements and the technologies covered include the following:

Customer	Sector	Technology
BBVA	EMEA – Financial Services	Multidomain Orchestration
Allianz	EMEA – Financial Services	Enterprise Architecture
Barclays	EMEA – Financial Services	Cloud Edge, Network Security
SAP	EMEA – Enterprise Software	Data Center, Multicloud
Thomson Reuters	EMEA – Financial Services	Enterprise Architecture
Deutsche Bank	EMEA – Financial Services	SD WAN, Cloud Edge
BHP Group	APJC – Mining, Energy	Data Center, Multicloud
Commonwealth Bank	APJC – Financial Services	Enterprise Architecture
Telstra	APJC – Telecommunications	Core WAN, Data Center
ANZ Bank	APJC – Financial Services	Data Center, Multicloud
Royal Bank of Canada (RBC)	Canada – Financial Services	Multidomain Orchestration
US Dept of Defense	US Federal – Government	Cloud Edge, Network Security
US Army	US Federal – Government	SD WAN, Full Stack Security
AT&T	Americas Service Provider	Multidomain Orchestration, SD WAN
Direct TV	Americas Service Provider	Data Center, Hybrid Cloud Utility
Equinix	Americas Service Provider	Cloud Edge, Network Security
Home Depot	GES Premier – Retail	Multidomain Orchestration
Ford Motor Company	GES Premier – Manufacturing	Network Security, Zero Trust
Wells Fargo Bank	GES Premier – Financial Services	SASE, Network Security
Navy Federal	GES East – Financial Services	Enterprise Architecture
Capital One	GES East – Financial Services	Data Center, Multicloud
Deloitte & Touche LLP	GES South – Professional Services	SASE, Network Security
FiServ	GES South – Financial Services	Data Center, Multicloud
Costco	GES West – Retail	Multidomain Orchestration
Boeing	GES West - Manufacturing	Multidomain Orchestration

INNOVATION SUMMARY

Brenden has demonstrated a strong commitment to leading complex customer engagements. For some of them, Cisco had no pre-existing solutions; under Brenden's leadership, they have since resulted in a steady output of innovation to solve the problems. Across a wide spectrum of customer scenarios spanning a variety of industry verticals and many technology disciplines, Brenden has proven to be highly adept at understanding and documenting the customer use case and related problems they are trying to solve, which is a crucial first step.

Brenden has been involved in several significant engagements, including with customers looking to modernize next-generation remote architectures and enablement for new customer-facing applications. Other examples

include building custom solutions that addressed creation of a hybrid cloud utility model and design of a discovery tool to address policy deployment. Both solutions advanced and were developed further and released as mainstream products in the Cisco+ and campus analytics portfolios with large potential TAMs.

In a final example, a customer and Cisco partnered to jointly architect a remote IoT management solution to address one of the high growth, strategic investment areas for the company. The innovation Brenden led has driven booked and pipeline revenue totaling \$225M and brought products to market with \$250M in booked and pipeline revenue. He has established a strong track record of generating innovation ideas and has built trust internally with the BEs.

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT SUMMARY

Brenden continuously invests in his professional and personal development, not only for himself, but to ensure his ability to continue to make a positive impact on Cisco business. He consistently volunteers to attend trainings, bootcamps, and internal VT programs, and not only receives trainings, but often subsequently delivers them to broader audiences. Brenden works to develop his soft skills as well as technical skills and takes what he learns to affect his engagement with Cisco customers and partners, as well as internal teams and Cisco leadership.

SE COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP SUMMARY

A strong advocate of the SE community, Brenden has spoken at 47 EBCs (both in-person and virtual) in the last 4 years. His communication skills and ability to connect with people at all levels, from technical architects to senior leaders, make him a highly sought-after speaker for a variety of events, from customer briefings and forums to global events such as CiscoLive. He drives content to the SE community by recording videos, hosting workshops, and building writing teams. He also personally mentors others, helping them achieve their own career goals.

BECOMING A DISTINGUISHED ARCHITECT SUMMARY

Becoming a distinguished architect would be a pinnacle achievement of Brenden's 26-year career at Cisco. It would give Brenden the chance to work side-side with the company's top engineers and push himself to reach new performance goals. Being in a distinguished architect role will enable Brenden to broaden his technology exposure even further and develop skills in areas that will benefit Cisco in the longer-term horizon-3 initiatives. Moving to a distinguished architect role would allow Brenden to grow his level of influence by expanding the reach of internal resources he interacts with daily. Brenden has exhibited strong, disciplined leadership and is already acting in a distinguished architect capacity; promoting him would increase opportunities to lead by both action and example.

By joining the distinguished architect ranks, Brenden's expertise would be more widely available to work with sales teams in the Americas, EMEAR, and APJC. Brenden's extensive work on field enablement would grow to a broader spectrum of topics with a much larger global impact. If Brenden became a distinguished architect his background as both a PA and DA would give him a unique skillset to mentor future candidates. Cisco would benefit because of the broad diversity of projects he's involved with today, his execution-oriented work ethic, his strong teamwork mindset, and his dedication to innovation and solving customer problems, thereby extending his span of influence. An expanded set of customers would give him a broader aggregate view to drive development of cross domain solutions and simplified consumption models delivering greater business impact externally and internally.

DIRECT LEADER SUMMARY

As a member of the GES CTO team, and prior to that as member of the GES Central team, Brenden is a critical resource providing engineering thought leadership not just for strategic account engagements but also for broad Cisco strategy influence. He drives multiarchitecture solutions and value statements that underpin the GES strategy and our market success.

Brenden is highly effective at influencing BE leadership through deep relationships with executives and product management teams, and he is an active participant in multiple SWAT teams which are shaping Cisco go to market strategies globally. His degree of influence is evident by the extensive list of letters of recommendation he has received from executive leadership. He provides additional leadership through mentoring others, developing and

delivering broad enablement sessions, being a featured speaker at customer EBC's, being an SEVT advisor and regularly presenting at Cisco Live. These activities have allowed him to build a broad span of influence inside and outside of Cisco resulting in a significant global impact.

Brenden's body of work as a Principal Architect in the GES for the past 4 years makes it clear to us as his direct leadership team that he is an excellent candidate to be promoted to Distinguished Architect. The criteria for becoming a DA is extremely challenging but we believe Brenden has risen to meet the challenge. Additional details are given in the *Direct Leader Recommendation* section below.

Direct Leader Recommendation

Brenden is a long time Principal Architect in GES having been promoted to PA approximately 4 years ago, first working in GES Central and more recently as a member of the GES CTO team. Brenden is intensely customer focused, and very passionate about our execution on bringing competitive solutions to market that meet the current and future needs of our customers leading to our market success. Brenden's impact and span of influence is significant through his customer activities, his influencing of our solution development and go to market strategies, and his mentoring and educating of others. As Brenden's direct leadership team we are proud to make the recommendation of Brenden for the position of Distinguished Architect and are delighted to highlight his impact, achievements and performance.

Brenden is the go-to strategic resource for many top accounts where he has been directly involved in securing critical wins in the areas of Cloud Networking, SD-WAN, Security and Campus Networking against competitors such as Arista, VMware and others. As a member of the GES CTO team Brenden has responsibility for several key areas of strategic focus including:

- Multidomain Automation and Orchestration
- SASE and FSO Offers
- Enterprise Architectures and Hybrid Cloud Architectures
- Zero Trust
- End to End Policy and Segmentation

Brenden's significant span of influence has enabled him to have an outsized impact on Cisco's business both inside and outside of GES. Since being promoted to PA, Brenden has directly impacted \$1.65B in revenue across many accounts including United Health Group, Progressive Insurance, Huntington Bank, Anthem Healthcare and others. He also provides technical leadership, mentorships and innovation that has a broad influence across Cisco. Here are just a few examples of his many activities:

- Active member of the SASE and MDO SWAT Teams
- Presenter to executives such as Todd Nightingale, Kip Compton and Scott Harrell
- Highly sought-after speaker for customer executives having spoken at 47 EBC's
- Field leader for Meraki go to market strategy for large scale use cases
- Field leader for EN&C Day2 operations and ACI roadmap feature enhancements
- Regular presenter at Cisco Live and is a Cisco Live Session Group Manager
- Value Engineering and Performance IT Practice Lead delivering multiple field enablement sessions and leading several customer engagements

Brenden also strongly embodies the Cisco culture of giving back by enthusiastically providing technical leadership through the mentorship, education and development of others. He never says no to a request for help and has a broad impact on talent development both inside and outside of Cisco through a number of activities:

- Currently mentoring 8 people who are working towards their PA candidacy

Cisco Distinguished Architect Nomination - Brenden Buresh (bburesh)

- Coordinated a global SASE training workshop and delivered it on 5 separate occasions for field and partner engineers
- Delivered Arista, VMware and Zscaler competitive blackbelt training
- Is a Cloud Networking SEVT Field Advisor for ACI and Nexus-OS
- Coordinated, developed and delivered Cloud Edge workshops to customer, partner and Cisco engineers

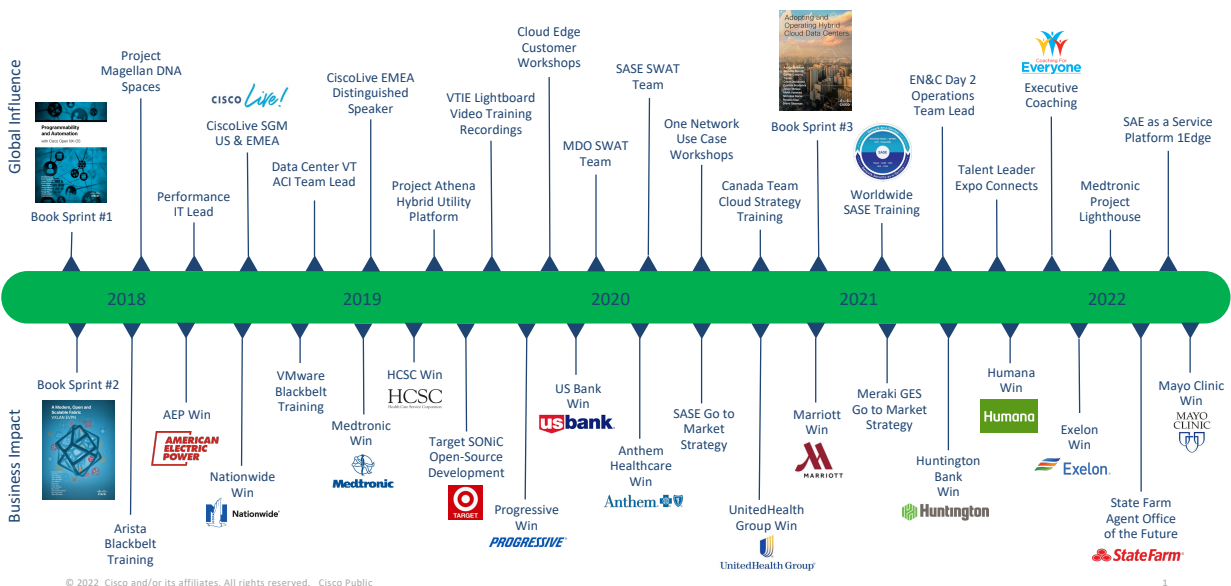
Brenden is an influencer, leader, innovator and educator who leads by example and is constantly in very high demand. He takes a starring role in customer engagements whether its presenting at executive briefing sessions, driving value engineering architectural solutions via Performance IT, taking on our top competition, or driving detailed customer workshops. He is an innovator, taking his deep customer experience and insights to workstreams like the MDO and SASE SWAT teams to help shape our solutions to meet the needs of the market. Brenden is an educator, running numerous internal, partner and customer large scale enablement events, speaking at Cisco Live, and mentoring numerous PA candidates.

The criteria for becoming a DA is challenging but we believe Brenden has met the challenge. It's important to draw your attention to the impressive list of DA letters of recommendation Brenden has received from Cisco BE executives, sales executives, customers and the DA community.

As we plan Brenden's future should he be successful in becoming a DA we will be sure to support and encourage his engagement within the global DA community. The DA community is critical to Cisco's success as we transform our business. We believe Brenden has an important role to play in the DA community which will provide him the platform to have an even broader impact on GES, Cisco and across the industry. We will have him focus in areas such as multidomain orchestration where we need to coexist and partner with solutions such as Terraform and Ansible. We will also have him focus on multiarchitecture value engineering solutions that will help drive Cisco success in our go to market offers such as Hybrid Cloud, Hybrid Work, SASE and FSO. And we will keep him working with our most strategic customers where he will have both immediate and long-term impacts.

When we look at Brenden's influence, impact, and overall body of work, we believe he has outperformed the expectations of a PA and indeed meets the challenging criteria of a DA. Therefore we respectfully submit Brenden for consideration for the role of Distinguished Architect.

Brenden Buresh PA Timeline



Global Impact

Project and Date	Impact
Cisco EN&C Ideas Portal Feb 2020 – Present	To address the issue of having a disjointed process of providing input to BE teams on new product development and the addition of new features on existing products, Cisco introduced the Cisco EN&C Ideas Portal (also known as the AHA tool). Brenden was approached by senior leadership from DC field teams to lead the Day-2 Operations team and to join the ACI team. As a result of Brenden's efforts driving cross-domain ND strategy, the BE developed a broader set of platform integrations like ThousandEyes, Intersight, AppD, and SD WAN. In his role on the ACI team, Brenden also had global impact on a more mature product by redirecting focus to cloud ACI integrations, SaaS enablement, SD WAN connectivity for public cloud extension, and capability enhancements to close competitive gaps with Arista, VMware, and Aviatrix. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
SASE Go-to-Market Strategy Jan 2020 – Present	In most early SASE sales engagements, Cisco competed head-to-head focused on individual technical capabilities and was regularly losing deals. A new field-driven SASE go-to-market strategy was devised to better address Cisco's shortcomings and improve deal winning percentage. Brenden was one of the leaders who designed and helped implement this sales strategy, which is having global impact with all front-line AM/SE teams, the GSSO teams, and the SASE specialist teams and will improve revenue projections as it becomes mainstream. It also is directly affecting how we align staffing and subject matter expertise to ensure Cisco captures market share. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Worldwide SASE Training Jun 2020 – Jan 2021	SASE field training was deemed a high priority action item by the SASE SWAT Team. Brenden took on the primary leadership role to get training developed, organized, and delivered across all Worldwide Sales. Brenden made a global impact through planning and arranging delivery of SASE training to Worldwide sales organization across all Cisco's main geographies inclusive of Americas, EMEA, APJC, and the extended Partner Community. This resulted in ~3,500 field resources participating and successfully completing training with an average survey score of 4.76. This also spawned the creation of the SASE Technical Go-to-Market Team, the SASE Tiger Team, and the SASE Workshop 2.0 Working Group, which later delivered a 6x30 mins session training series as direct follow-up. This training has resulted in a much stronger level of sales engagement and forecasted deal pipeline for SASE. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Competitive Intelligence	Brenden's sustained competitive efforts focused on VMware, Arista, and Zscaler have had a global impact on Cisco product management and engineering across platform development, feature delivery, and roadmap priorities. He has impacted go-to-market plans and competitive sales engagement for these competitors by consistently generating and updating field collateral. He has been at the forefront of driving training initiatives for the Worldwide Sales organization developing VMware Blackbelt, Arista Blackbelt, and Worldwide SASE curriculum, including acting as a presenter and Q&A manager. Brenden has led competitive education efforts for the DC virtual teams, partnered with INSBU to update competitive VMware and

	Arista collateral, and presented at BE-sponsored competitive training sessions. He has also regularly presented Cisco's SASE technology story in virtual EBCs and in support of SASE RFPs. Brenden's PA nomination package detailed his work leading the VMware NSX team and co-leading the Arista competitive team. As a PA, he has continued that work to the present time and has made similar efforts for Zscaler. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Competitive Intelligence – Zscaler Jun 2019 – Present	Zscaler is Cisco's primary competitor in cloud security opportunities. Brenden has been very involved in evaluating the Zscaler competitive risks and designating them as a tier-1 competitive threat, and he's been a leader in the field addressing Zscaler competitive issues from the onset of the SASE market. Among other instrumental activities, Brendon developed worldwide SE SASE training, collaborated to create training curriculum and collateral, and has delivered multiple sessions in the US, EMEA, APJC, and to Cisco partners. Brenden's leadership has resulted in worldwide trainings in how to defeat this major competitor. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Competitive Intelligence – VMware Aug 2012 – Present	Brenden performed a pivotal role in capturing customer and internal field data to make a case to promote VMware to a tier-1 competitor, which eventually led to the Voltron project being created. Brendon has been instrumental in reshaping the sales motion playbook against VMware and building the VMware Blackbelt training curriculum. As the DC-SEVT track owner for ACI for multiple years, Brendon integrated the Voltron training curriculum into bi-annual VT events and is a repeat session owner and presenter. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Competitive Intelligence – Arista Aug 2012 – Present	With Arista's expansion into campus wired and wireless networking as well as merchant routing platforms, Brenden was one of the first field resources to start capturing updated information and was directly responsible for helping create an expanded set of competitive collateral inclusive of DC, campus, core, and edge services routing products. Brenden was part of the team that designed the Arista Blackbelt training curriculum and, as DC-SEVT track owner for ACI for multiple years, he integrated the Arista training curriculum into bi-annual VT events and is a repeat session owner and presenter. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.

Span of Influence

Project and Date	Impact
SASE SWAT Team Jan 2020 – Present	A small number of field SWAT teams are focused on Cisco's highest priority technology initiatives. Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) was one of the first key areas identified for a team. When it was created, Brenden was selected as an original member. The team meets regularly and is chartered to track a set of workstreams that Brenden has either led individually, co-led as part of smaller teams, or contributed to as part of the larger group. Brenden's leadership, influence, and contributions as part of the SASE SWAT Team and related initiatives have impacted Cisco's strategy, product development, and go-to-market efforts on a global basis. Working directly with

	the BE engineering and product management teams for Cisco+ Secure Connect and Cisco+ Secure Connect Choice, this has directly impacted roadmap and delivery timeframes, feature and capability prioritizations, and scalability improvements for large GES and USPS customers. It has also raised awareness of competitive gaps that need to be addressed for Cisco to succeed in the SASE market. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
MDO SWAT Team Jan 2020 – Present	Multidomain Orchestration (MDO) was another essential area identified for a SWAT team, and Brenden was selected as an original member. The team meets regularly and is chartered to track a set of workstreams that Brenden has either led individually, co-led as part of smaller teams, or contributed to as part of the larger group. Brenden’s leadership, influence, and contributions on the MDO SWAT Team have guided Cisco’s strategy, platform investments, and go-to-market plans globally. He has been instrumental in identifying solution gaps in Cisco’s platforms and outlining details of portfolio shortcomings. He also drove technical requirements and use cases to facilitate creating a business case for a Cisco MDO platform. Brenden has been a field leader building MDO customer messaging and working to drive customer interest and engagements for early platform adoption. Additionally, he has worked closely with the BE teams to outline plans to support large-scale GES and USPS customers by expanding feature capabilities and supported use cases on the MDO platform, and he has been extremely active supporting MDO training enablement efforts for the field and CX services teams. These contributions are shaping Cisco’s platform plans and helping Cisco retain an industry-leading competitive position. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Meraki GES Go-to-Market Strategy Mar 2020 – Aug 2021	Cisco is taking strategic steps to increase scalability of the Meraki platform and align campus wired+wireless switching products to Meraki cloud management. To align with this strategic direction, Central Area leadership requested Brenden to co-lead an initiative to get the field teams trained and empowered to position Meraki more broadly. Brenden’s contributions and leadership driving the Meraki GES go-to-market strategy has made significant global impact both internally and with customers. Expanding Meraki to more GES and USPS accounts required greater platform scale and feature development velocity, which directly impacted product management and engineering commitments. Building training collateral to drive field enablement pushed GES and USPS account teams to position Meraki more regularly, which expanded market penetration and further increased revenues at 300% Y-Y growth rate. Brenden has been and continues to be influential in the emerging SASE market, where Cisco is facing strong competition, helping drive engineering and product management roadmaps for Cisco+ Secure Connect as it scales to meet GES and USPS requirements. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.

Performance IT Lead Jun 2018 – Aug 2021	To address the limitations of Cisco's transaction-oriented sales structure, Cisco created Performance IT which asserts a business and ROI-led approach of strengthening technical architecture with the objective to drive larger deals and create trusted advisor relationships with customers. Brenden was one of the first Area field leads supporting the Performance IT practice. Brenden's role as one of the first area level Performance IT practice leads has impacted how Cisco engages with customers globally. As one of the first field resources trained on the Performance IT model, he turned around and designed and delivered training to the broader field to drive enablement and establish best practices. He was also instrumental in creating a process for successfully identifying prospective Performance IT customers and driving development of reference architectures in data center, hybrid cloud, and security. Even more importantly, Brenden constructed how cross-domain architecture is designed and implemented leveraging automation and orchestration. Between his broader contributions and the engagements he supported, Brenden drove hundreds of millions of dollars in direct revenue. Additionally, he helped transition and map Performance IT to Business Value Architecture, which has significantly increased pipeline revenue from GES and USPS customers. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.
Pairwise Integrations/Multidomain Policy Apr 2018 - Present	Cisco initiated a project to build pairwise integrations between DC, EN, and SD WAN domains with a multidomain policy application to distribute end-end policy across domains. Brenden was one of a few field advisors who worked directly with customers and BEs to get these capabilities delivered to market. Brenden has been involved in this project from the beginning, compiling requirements and collaborating with other team members and engineering, providing information necessary for building application framework and workflows. He also created multiple revisions of collateral intended for field consumption, organized DC-SEVT sessions on pairwise integration and multidomain policy and provided input on roadmap plans and functional specs. The first two versions of the integration design had several issues and were abandoned, but positive outcomes were realized from those efforts. The v3.0 is currently in development, with more complete requirements and policy exchange for multiple use cases. A top-level tool is also being considered to simplify deployment and support a much broader set of managed platforms. More details are located in the Business Impact section of this document.

Industry Impact

CiscoLive SGM US & EMEA, 2018– Present: CiscoLive is Cisco's premier customer event, attracting thousands of attendees annually in the US, EMEA, and APJC. Brenden has been speaking regularly at the US event since 2014 and the EMEA and APJC events since 2015, capturing Distinguished Speaker awards in the EMEA and APJC venues (Europe 2019, Australia 2015). He's delivered tectorials and breakouts, presented DevNet sessions, conducted seminars, and met 1:1 with hundreds of customers at MTE sessions.

In 2018, the CiscoLive team was looking for a Session Group Manager (SGM) on the data center track for both the US and EMEA events. Brenden was selected to join the 4-member lineup, and his participation in this role continues today. In this expanded capacity, he is building the entire data center session catalog, selecting speakers, mentoring and training speakers, and creating learning maps and customer journeys. Brenden's duties and impact include the following:

- Reviewed, scored, ranked, and accepted call for paper (CFP) submissions to be presented at CiscoLive US and EMEA events, and provided feedback to speakers with declined sessions
- Coached prospective CiscoLive speakers on abstract writing, best practices for session technical-level and content creation, delivery timing, and speaking guidelines
- Partnered with speakers to generate session outlines, provide feedback on and make modifications to content creation, conduct dry run practice sessions, and outlined speaker expectations
- Responsible for construction of daily session schedule for technical seminars, breakout sessions, hands-on labs for data center track including Nexus, ACI, UCS, Hyperflex, and MDS
- Originated the idea of using learning maps for data center catalog, which mapped out customer journeys for basic, intermediate, and advanced sessions across Nexus, ACI, and UCS
- Coordinated the first on-demand event (CiscoLive US 2020), the first hybrid event (CiscoLive US 2021), and the first combined global event (CiscoLive EMEA/US 2022)

Brenden's leadership and contributions as a data center track SGM for US and EMEA events has impacted Cisco internally, customers externally, and the broader industry. He has been directly responsible for selecting the data center track content and speakers presenting to audiences totaling 40,000 customers and partners across the US and EMEA events. The learning maps created by the data center SGM team for the US event to help customers build optimized schedules based on steadily advancing technical levels of content are now being used at the EMEA event and have expanded to all other SGM tracks. Brenden has supported a large group of new and experienced speakers to create sessions, write abstracts, build content, and deliver practice sessions, with the intention of creating the strongest and deepest industry event Cisco can offer customers. The results of these efforts include steadily increasing attendance and consistently improving speaker and overall scores at both US and EMEA events. Creation of on-demand, hybrid, and global events is now expected to be a permanent component of future CiscoLive events.

Enterprise Architecture Customer Workshops, 2018 – Present: Historically, Cisco has separated technology domains to organize product management, engineering, and field sales, which dictates the customer engagement model. Field assets are specialized and aligned to technology domains, causing disconnects when customer requirements stipulate multiple domains and an enterprise architecture engagement approach. Brenden was amongst the first field resources to align and focus on enterprise architecture covering multiple technologies with greater depth and breadth. One of his primary tools supporting enterprise architecture engagements was designing and delivering the customer workshops listed below.

Zero Trust Network Access, 2019 – Present: Example agenda from customer workshops presented at Huntington Bank, Nationwide Insurance, Humana Healthcare, Mayo Clinic, Abbott Labs, State Farm, Caterpillar, and others.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Cisco Zero Trust Operation | b. Duo Access Gateway |
| a. Establish Trust | c. Duo Network Gateway |
| b. Enforce Trust-Based Access | 4. Cisco Zero Trust – Workload |
| c. Continuous Trust Verification | a. Tetration Architecture |
| 2. Cisco Zero Trust Architecture | b. Application Dependency Mapping |
| a. Workforce | c. Hybrid Cloud Segmentation |
| b. Workload | 5. Cisco Zero Trust – Workplace |
| c. Workplace | a. ISE Architecture |
| 3. Cisco Zero Trust – Workforce | b. DNA Center Architecture |
| a. Duo Architecture | c. Software Defined Access |

- 6. Secure Access Services Edge (SASE)
 - a. Umbrella Architecture
 - b. Remote Access Architecture
 - c. SD WAN Architecture

Cloud Edge/Internet Centric Design, 2018 – Present: Example agenda from customer workshops presented at 3M, Marriott International, Fannie Mae, Humana Healthcare, Kroger, Progressive Insurance, Best Buy, and others.

- 1. Data Center Security Design
 - a. Centralized DC
 - b. Distributed Edge
 - c. Cloud Enabled
- 2. Cloud Edge Design
 - a. SD WAN Connectivity
 - b. Middle Mile Optimization
 - c. Cloud onRamp
- 3. Secure Access Services Edge (SASE)
 - a. NaaS – RAVPN, SD WAN
 - b. SecaaS – Umbrella SIG
 - c. Traffic Insights – ThousandEyes
- 4. Zero Trust Network Access
 - a. Workforce
 - b. Workplace
 - c. Workload
- 5. Hybrid Multicloud
 - a. Cloud Controller
 - b. Server Management
 - c. Edge Computing
- 6. Full Stack Observability
 - a. Application Performance Management
 - b. Workload Management
 - c. Network Monitoring

Hybrid Multicloud Design, 2018 – Present: Example agenda from customer workshops presented at UnitedHealth Group, Anthem Healthcare, US Bank, Zions Bank, Medtronic, Target Corporation, Northern Trust, and others.

- 1. Next Generation Data Center Architecture
 - a. Carrier Neutral Facilities (CNFs)
 - b. Public Cloud Integration
 - c. Cloud Native Applications
- 2. Customer Cloud Adoption Strategies
 - a. Cloud First
 - b. Cloud All-In
 - c. Multicloud
- 3. Cloud Security and Policy Models
 - a. Fully Distributed
 - b. Centralized Cloud Edge
 - c. Cloud Consumed
- 4. Building CoLo-Based Cloud Edge
 - a. Direct Internet Access
 - b. SD WAN Architecture
 - c. Cloud Cross Connect
- 5. Cloud Based Security
 - a. Security to the Cloud
 - b. Security for the Cloud
 - c. Security from the Cloud
- 6. Cloud Security Architecture
 - a. Segmentation
 - b. Visibility
 - c. Threat Protection

Brenden's willingness to diversify and focus more broadly on enterprise architecture and deliver customer workshops in support of that has influenced Cisco internally, customers externally, and the broader industry. He's led by example generating the workshop outlines, developing customer content, and individually delivering the workshops, including interactive whiteboarding sessions typically in single or multiple half-day sessions. His ability to demonstrate proficiency across Cisco's broad portfolio and design end-end architecture has resulted in competitors attempting to mimic the same sales engagement strategy. Workshops typically jumpstart multiple customer projects and result in follow-up invites for recurring or expanded topic sessions and generating meaningful revenue pipeline for Cisco. This workshop often establishes Cisco as the trusted advisor for the account and can deflect competitive threats. Brenden has mentored teammates on workshop best practices, contributed to joint sessions, and was instrumental in getting the enterprise architecture workshop concept embedded into Business Value Architecture.

Target Open-Source Development SONiC, 2018 – Present: Target Corporation is the 7th largest retailer with an IT networking practice committed to open-source software, DevOps and network programmability, and disaggregation of hardware and software. When Target adopted ACI fabric in their DCs, they gained strong familiarity with the NX-9K switch platform. However, for their 1,900 stores, they decided a white box switch solution was more aligned to their goals. Specifically, they planned to run NX-9K hardware without NX-OS

software, preferring to run open-source SONiC/SAI software. Brenden worked with Target and the data center BE to drive development of this solution. Brenden's involvement includes the following:

- Collected customer requirements and use cases to help write business case justification for developing SONiC/SAI software support on NX-9K hardware platforms (93180YC-FX, 9332C, and 9364C)
- Partnered with BE product management and engineering to prioritize and make roadmap commitments for specific SONiC/SAI feature needs – PoE, MGig, 802.1x, 40Gig/100Gig QSFP optics
- Assisted customer in writing detailed test plans for NX-9K hardware, SONiC/SAI software, and customer-developed features, and worked with the customer to successfully complete testing
- Explored partnership with Target, Kroger, and other GES customers to drive further SONiC development running on top of SAI/OCP (Open Compute Project)
- Work done on behalf of Target with SONiC/SAI has been upstream committed and integrated into the SONiC open-source Git code repositories (Microsoft)

Development work done in partnership with Target has been highlighted in several BU blog posts on SONiC/SAI, featured in DC-SEVT sessions, and integrated into Cisco documentation.

Brenden's partnership and contributions to getting SONiC/SAI open-source code supported on Cisco hardware has impacted Cisco internally, customers externally, and the broader industry. Cisco has historically been portrayed as "closed and proprietary," which has resulted in losing business at customers like Target, but the development efforts on SONiC/SAI demonstrated a renewed commitment to open software platforms. Important and widely used features like PoE, MGig, and 802.1x are now available in SONiC/SAI and have been upstreamed into the main code repositories that are now available industry wide. Internal account teams with customers looking for disaggregated solutions or in competitive scenarios now have a SONiC/SAI solution as an available option to win business. Cisco has gained more credibility in the open-source community with OCP and Microsoft because of the SONiC/SAI work. The SONiC/SAI project jointly developed between Cisco and Target represented a strategic investment for the data center BE and has been featured in public Cisco communications, on the internal BE website, and at DC-SEVT events.

Thomson Reuters Hybrid Cloud Utility, 2017 – 2021: Thomson Reuters is a large global account with major data center and cloud access hubs in Minneapolis, New York, and London. They're undergoing a major shift to outsourcing, public cloud, and consumption platforms — managed service and SaaS. The customer contacted Cisco about building an integrated data center stack inclusive of network, compute, and storage available in a flexible pay-as-you-grow consumption model. Cisco had all the necessary individual products but had not created a platform with the requisite go-to-market structure. Partnering with Thomson Reuters, Brenden led the development of a hybrid cloud utility. Brenden's involvement and impact included the following:

- Gathered customer requirements and use cases to help author business case justification for construction of hybrid cloud utility platform — managed service offer evolving to SaaS
- Identified design for hybrid cloud utility platform — ACI network fabric, UCS compute, NetApp storage, CWOM, UCSD, CloudCenter, NSO — fully integrated with ServiceNow
- Partnered with cloud BE leadership to work through consumption details on "pay as you grow" and "pay as you use," evaluated competitive offers from HPE Greenlake and Dell/VMware Cloud Foundation (VCF)
- Collaborated with the Strategic Engagement Team (SET) to build rate card billable details for offered services, BM as a service, VM as a service, Hadoop as a Service, and Container as a Service
- Hybrid cloud utility offer evolved into Project Athena, which was branded Cisco+ Hybrid Cloud — added Intersight, UCS HyperFlex, MDS switching, Nexus w/NDFC, Nexus Dashboard
- Created additional customer facing as a service offers — facilities utility (CNF), WAN utility, security services utility, visibility services utility, analytics services utility, and monitoring services utility

Brenden's leadership and coordination for getting a hybrid cloud utility offer developed has impacted Cisco internally, customers externally, and the broader industry. Traditionally, Cisco has sold individual products and the

customer has owned the integration responsibility of either doing it themselves or employing a partner to fulfill the solution. The creation of a hybrid cloud utility was one of the first times Cisco designed and built a pre-integrated full stack offer available as a consumable service. These efforts served as the foundation for Project Athena, which became Cisco+ Hybrid Cloud — the first official offer in the Cisco as-a-Service portfolio. The hybrid cloud utility platform provides Cisco customers an on-premises option with integrated public cloud experience and multiple consumption choices. Internal Cisco account teams now have options aligned to the industry direction of hybrid cloud but available as a service, allowing them to compete more effectively with HP, Dell, VMware, and others. The adjacent work on more service utilities, such as WAN, security, visibility, analytics, and monitoring were a precursor to more Cisco+ offers.

Business Impact

American Electric Power (AEP), 2018 – 2021

Revenue Impact: \$27M in FY18, \$23M in FY19, \$15M in FY20, \$13M in FY21, Total Revenue - \$78M

AEP is one of the largest electric utilities in the US and currently ranks #204 on the Fortune 500. Located in Columbus, OH, AEP services 5.5 million customers in 11 states, generating \$15B in annual revenue. Brenden was engaged from 2018 through 2021 when AEP was under intense competitive pressure from Arista, having for the first-time lost DC refresh business. Brenden directed the Cisco response for a customer RFP to modernize infrastructure, increase bandwidth, and improve performance of the core MPLS backbone network.

Core MPLS/SR Network: In February 2018, AEP issued an RFP to replace their core MPLS backbone network called AMEN. Primary competition for the RFP was Arista and Juniper, with Arista being the bigger threat given a recent DC switching win featuring CloudVision management and their focused goal to establish themselves in the merchant routing space. Over a 6-month period, Brenden led the Cisco team designing next-generation core WAN architecture based on NCS platform running MPLS/LDP with a long-term plan to transition over to Segment Routing (SR). Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Partnered closely across domains with service provider BE resources to build a design offering stability with MPLS/LDP but also a plan to transition to and leverage SR technology
- Increased backbone bandwidth to 10G/40G with plans for 100G to expand customer density and capacity and lower overall network operating costs
- Worked with CX Services resources to build out a competitive POC test plan focused on proven MPLS/LDP and a migration plan to gradually introduce SR
- Created one of first global enterprise RFP responses competing against lower cost merchant routing vendors to highlight Cisco routing technology advantages
- Provided a customer profile readout to Stef Eller's competitive team highlighting how the RFP was authored to combat Arista merchant routing
- Presented Arista competitive win on Midwest Atlantic Area SE All-Hands quarterly call, which reached ~60 participants

Financial impact of the AEP core routing win: \$3.5M in SP/EN product and services, annual revenues \$27M in FY18, \$23M in FY19, \$15M in FY20, \$13M in FY21, and total revenue of \$78M.

Competitive impact: It stopped Arista from gaining a larger foothold in other areas in the account.

Strategic impact: It created a blueprint for how to partner with service provider BE and CX Services to win one of first GES merchant routing deals.

Overall customer impact: Upgrading the AMEN transport network to increase customer capacity, improve overall network performance, and re-establish Cisco amongst AEP's key strategic vendors.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Anthem Healthcare, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$32M in FY18, \$55M in FY19, \$38M in FY20, \$69M in FY21, Total Revenue \$194M

Anthem is the largest US health insurance provider in the Blue Cross Blue Shield Association, with 40M network members. Headquartered in Indianapolis, IN, Anthem ranks #23 on the Fortune 500 with \$121B in annual revenue. Anthem presents unique challenges attributed to the fact that multiple large outsource vendors (IBM, ATT) are part of planning, implementation, and operations. Brenden has been engaged with this account since 2018, directing major customer initiatives to key strategic wins in the DCs and carrier neutral facilities (CNF).

Core DC/CNF Fabrics: Anthem commissioned a project to upgrade their Richmond and Harrisonburg DCs from a legacy Nexus 7K/5K/2K VPC design over to VXLAN fabrics. Both Arista and VMware NSX provided sustained competitive pressure. Encompassing multiple projects, Brenden led architecture work establishing core ACI fabric franchises in the primary DC locations, core VXLAN-EVPN fabrics with DCNM franchises in the CNF facilities in Ashburn, Dallas, and Chicago, and Nexus Dashboard for Day-2 operations and visibility across all primary sites. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Led large-scale ACI MultiPod designs of 2 clusters in Richmond with 450 leaf switches and 3 clusters in Williamsburg with 225 leaf switches, respectively
- Directed a distributed hybrid DC project in 3 Equinix CNFs settling on DCNM fabrics optimized for transit routing, service aggregation, and cloud connectivity
- Worked through repeated lifecycle fabric upgrades from 40G to 100G to 400G bandwidth and transition from ACI MultiPod to ACI MultiSite architecture
- Hosted multiple onsite customer whiteboard design workshops to reach key architecture milestones with customer, CX Services, and outsource partners
- Arranged a 2-day onsite BE roadmap workshop with Ronak Desai (SVP Engineering) and Thomas Scheibe (VP of Product Management) to align on technology plans
- Partnered with customer and the Cisco DC business unit to drive key product requirements for ACI fabric scale, multi ACI fabric management, and Day-2 operations capabilities

Financial impact of the Anthem DC franchise wins: \$25M of DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$32M in FY18, \$55M in FY19, \$38M in FY20, \$69M in FY21 and total revenue of \$194M.

Competitive impact: By leveraging Cisco's core fabric architectures, we were able to keep both VMware and Arista in diminished roles.

Strategic impact: Building a long-term sustained relationship with Cisco BE leadership.

Overall customer impact: Building out a hybrid cloud operating model, enabling Anthem to introduce new products and services to market more rapidly.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Eli Lilly and Company, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: Potential Large-Scale SASE and Thousand Eyes Wins for \$25M in FY22, Total Revenue \$25M

Eli Lilly is one of the largest pharmaceutical companies in the US and currently ranks #118 on the Fortune 500. Based in Indianapolis, IN, Eli Lilly has consistently been viewed as an innovator producing leading-edge drugs and generating \$24.5B in annual revenue. In June 2021, Central Area senior management identified Brenden as the lead SME to guide design and architecture for a customer RFP to migrate to SASE platform. This was a key inflection point for Eli Lilly in their multiyear plan to migrate to cloud-based network + security solutions.

SASE Platform: Eli Lilly issued an RFP for a SASE solution to migrate their premise-based security appliance solutions to a cloud-based platform. Vigorous competition was provided by Zscaler, Palo Alto, and Netskope, with Zscaler considered the front-runner based on the most current Gartner rankings. Brenden led the Cisco response from sales and CX Services, building a services-first architecture model focused on Umbrella SIG, Cisco+ Secure Connect Choice and Thousand Eyes. Equally importantly, the design integrated prior SD WAN and ISE investments to strengthen financials and simplify deployment. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Assembled cross domain SBG and IBNG resources to complete a comprehensive RFP response covering network as a service (NaaS) and security as a service (SECaaS)
- Provided solution architecture for Umbrella SIG, Viptela SD WAN, CiscoSecure Managed Remote Access (CSMRA), AnyConnect VPN, ISE, Duo, and ThousandEyes
- Identified and implemented completely new SASE messaging and response methodology, leading with network-first and disguising architecture weaknesses
- Worked with NSBU resources to integrate NDA information on Cisco+ Secure Connect into the RFP response, and arranged pre-FCS demos with BE resources
- Wrote the RFP executive summary, built the final customer presentation, and led the team's RFP presentation and interactive question/answer with customer
- Partnered with CX Services and WWT to build POC test plan focused on differentiation against Zscaler, awaiting completion of scheduled POC testing

Financial impact of the Eli Lilly SASE deal: A potential 5-year product EA with CX Services totaling \$25M in revenue for FY22, total projected revenue of \$25M

Competitive impact: One of the first large global GES deals in the SASE space against Zscaler where Cisco reached the final round of consideration, preservation of SD WAN franchise, established Thousand Eyes franchise

Strategic impact: Creation of a new sales motion leading with networking and using executive messaging to win key SASE control point.

Customer impact: Leveraging SASE to accelerate Eli Lilly's product development cycle and increased efficiency integrating mergers and acquisitions.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Exelon Corporation, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: End-to-end business transformation \$118M FY21 deal, Total Revenue \$118M

Exelon is one of the largest diversified energy companies in the US, operating in 48 states, Washington DC, and Canada. With corporate offices in Chicago, IL, Exelon services 11M customers and ranks as the largest utility on the Fortune 500 at #92 with \$33B in revenue. Brenden was first engaged in 2018 and later in 2020 brought in to lead design work on multidomain orchestration. Exelon was starting a large transformation project working towards to be cross domain architecture, but they lacked a plan for domain integrations and an automation framework.

MSX Orchestration: Exelon had completed a lengthy Performance IT engagement across their primary domains, which included data center, core routing + switching, SD WAN, cloud edge, Meraki, campus/branch, and security. CX Services had proposed an automation factory model but was unconvinced they could deliver what was planned with custom-built tooling that lacked engineering support. Brenden redirected the project to leverage MSX for multidomain orchestration, creating a design that resulted in a single operator tool to address main customer use cases. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Partnered with CX Services to discover and document customer use case requirements for cross domain integration including 3rd party tools
- Completed a thorough internal product analysis between NSO, BPA, MSX, and individual domain controllers to identify MSX as candidate platform
- Collaborated with Bryn Pounds (PA) to create MSX training, including collateral, whiteboard, and demonstration, which was delivered to the Systems Integration Architect (SIA) team
- Audited the customer use case matrix to identify off-the-shelf MSX capability gaps, and then wrote the business justification for the creation of additional service packs
- Worked with NSBU Product Management and Engineering to scope requirements and justify additional customer use case service packs
- Created broader business justification for CX Services to leverage MSX orchestration and integrations across a broader spectrum of GES customers

Financial impact of Exelon multidomain orchestration: End-to-end business transformation \$118M FY21 deal, total revenues of \$118M.

Competitive impact: Enabled Cisco to capture key control points, facilitated integration between domain controllers, assured CX Services delivery of automation framework.

Strategic impact: One of the first GES customers with CX Services utilizing MSX platform for multidomain orchestration.

Customer impact: Ability to deliver end-end service creation for automation, segmentation, and policy use cases from a single orchestration tool.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Health Care Service Corporation (HCSC), 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$3M in FY18, \$20M in FY19, \$29M in FY20, \$14M in FY21, Total Revenue \$66M

HCSC is the country's largest customer-owned health insurer. Located in Chicago, IL, HCSC services 17M members in all 50 states, Washington DC, and Puerto Rico and generates annual revenue of \$47B. Brenden was brought into HCSC in early 2018 and has remained engaged for 4 years working to influence and build a hybrid cloud design. As lead architect, he guided the Cisco team on a customer-issued RFP for DC fabric and hybrid cloud infrastructure, fighting off strong incumbent competition from VMware NSX.

Hybrid Cloud Franchise: HCSC issued an RFP in the spring of 2018 for DC fabric architecture to enable hybrid cloud and replace aging infrastructure that was experiencing outages attributed to large, stretched, layer-2 domains. HCSC had a long history and a sizable install base with VMware and had already started deploying NSX as their first hybrid cloud platform with strong advocacy from their cloud team. For Cisco's RFP response, Brenden developed a high availability multi-DC design focused on reducing risk, raising network availability, and improving operations. Brenden involvement and accomplishments include:

- Created multi-site ACI design at Waukegan and Dallas data centers with full brownfield migration plan integrating NSX for security and virtual services
- Collaborated closely with Cisco IT to arrange multiple customer meetings on ACI deployment best practices, lessons learned, and future expansion
- Partnered with CX Services to generate a multi-layer security segmentation plan with ACI providing macro segmentation and NSX handling micro segmentation
- Produced Cisco presentation materials and delivered the main elements of the presentation with interactive whiteboarding in the final round of customer RFP meetings
- Worked with the customer to create a distributed carrier neutral facility (CNF) strategy based on SD WAN and virtualized DMZ for hybrid multicloud enablement
- Provided the customer with a network transformation roadmap, which included expanding ACI to public cloud and building cloud-enabled visibility and telemetry

Financial impact of the HCSC hybrid cloud platform wins: \$10M in DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$3M in FY18, \$20M in FY19, \$29M in FY20, \$14M in FY21, and total revenue of \$66M.

Competitive impact: A joint Cisco + VMware solution that drove INSBU to endorse an official integration between ACI and NSX.

Strategic impact: Achieving trusted advisor status with the customer, as we were invited back for reference architectures in security, cloud edge, and observability.

Customer impact: Introducing a stable, proven, dependable, hybrid data center platform.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Humana Healthcare, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$42M in FY18, \$17M in FY19, \$53M in FY20, \$37M in FY21, Total Revenue \$149M

Humana is the 5th largest US health insurer and a leading provider of Medicare Advantage plans. Based in Louisville, KY, Humana services 16.8M total members and ranks #41 on the Fortune 500, generating annual revenues of \$77B. Humana had been a very challenging customer, with Cisco suffering competitive franchise losses to Arista, HP/Aruba, and VMware. Brenden came onboard in October 2018 and has stayed engaged for 4 years to lead an account turnaround by protecting install base franchises and winning back competitively held domains.

Arista Competitive Take-Out: Humana had transitioned to Arista switching in their LDC and SDC data centers. They struggled to finish the deployment and had sub-optimal network design, resulting in performance problems and repeated network outages. Brenden led a multi-year effort to take back the DC footprint and displace Arista and VMware. This project highlighted a multitude of other domains experiencing ongoing network challenges. He guided major project wins for SD WAN, branch switching, Internet edge + security, and remote access VPN. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Redesigned a multi-site standalone VXLAN EVPN network with DCNM in LDC and SDC data centers to address ongoing network performance problems
- Partnered with CX Services to build a full non-disruptive migration plan from legacy Cisco and Arista switching in preparation for open enrollment period
- Created a full zero touch managed services design for a “branch in a box” solution based on Meraki wired + wireless switching and Viptela SD WAN
- Produced a mini-series of educational workshops delivered onsite to senior leadership for security and Zero Trust, secure cloud edge, and hybrid multicloud
- Restructured the entire Internet edge routing and Internet security designs to address sub-optimal path selection and overburdened network capacity
- Transitioned the struggling Juniper and Aruba remote access VPN complex to Cisco FTD with Anyconnect-based design to accommodate 20K concurrent users

Financial impact of multiple Humana competitive wins: \$12M in DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$42M in FY18, \$17M in FY19, \$53M in FY20, \$37M in FY21, and total revenue of \$149M.

Competitive impact: Re-establishing Cisco incumbency in multiple key network and security domains.

Strategic impact: CxO level leadership repeatedly reaching out to Cisco first, trusting they were best positioned to address network and security issues.

Customer impact: Stabilizing network and building best practice design to ensure open enrollment period occurred seamlessly without service interruption.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Huntington Bank, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$26M in FY18, \$15M in FY19, \$33M in FY20, \$57M in FY21, Total Revenue \$131M

Huntington Bank was the 35th largest bank in the US, operating 840 branches across the Midwest. With corporate offices in Detroit, MI, Huntington recently acquired TCF Bank, adding 475 branches to make it the 27th largest US bank and estimated #400 on the Fortune 500 with \$8B in revenue. Huntington had been slow to upgrade and modernize their network infrastructure on a regular basis and was struggling with technology debt as a result. Brenden was brought in to lead an enterprise transformation program spanning 4 years between 2018 and 2022.

Enterprise Transformation: Like most large banks, the Huntington Bank network was built around two primary on-premises DCs with remote branches connecting via hub-spoke topology. With corporate advocating migration to hybrid cloud, routing connectivity was increasingly sub-optimal, campus and DC infrastructure lacked automation and suffered from slow provisioning, and overall application performance was sub-optimal, resulting in a poor user experience. Brenden led and contributed to major wins in branch, WAN, security, and DC architecture redesigns. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Organized and delivered multiple half-day customer whiteboard workshops on cloud edge architecture, software defined perimeter, and Zero Trust Network Access
- Constructed an end-end segmentation plan initiating from consumer, connecting to provider, and traversing branch, WAN, data center, and hybrid cloud
- Partnered with Equinix to build out a plan for right sizing the customer's data center footprint by moving to a geographically distributed CNF design leveraging ECX
- Redesigned centralized MPLS-based WAN to regionalized SD WAN aggregation using Direct Internet Access (DIA) to streamline cloud connectivity
- Created hybrid cloud focused data center architecture leveraging MultiSite ACI and UCS + Hyperflex with Intersight to improve automated service delivery
- Produced full-service branch design based on Cat9K switching and next generation WiFi-6 wireless infrastructure fully integrated with ISE and SD WAN

Financial impact of multiple HNB enterprise transformation wins: \$30M in EN/DC product and services, annual revenues of \$26M in FY18, \$15M in FY19, \$33M in FY20, \$57M in FY21, and total revenue of \$131M.

Competitive impact: Preserving and expanding current domain franchises against HP/Aruba, Dell/EMC, and VMware.

Strategic impact: Building area-wide Intent Based Networking (IBN) reference architecture other account teams could leverage with their customers.

Customer impact: A more agile, automated, and digitized network infrastructure to speed up new service delivery and acquisition integration.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Marriott International, 2018 – 2021

Revenue Impact: \$19M in FY18, \$15M in FY19, \$6M in FY20, \$14M in FY21, Total Revenue \$54M

Marriott is the second largest hotel chain worldwide, with more than 7,500 hotels and 14,000 rooms. Headquartered in Bethesda, MD, Marriott operates in 131 countries and ranks #293 on the Fortune 500, generating \$10.5B in annual revenue. Marriott was an early public cloud adopter moving aggressively to consolidate their DC footprint in MD and PA sites. Brenden was engaged on a sustained basis from 2018 to 2021 driving initiatives to diversify to a distributed carrier neutral facility (CNF) design optimized for cloud connectivity.

Global PoP Architecture: Marriott's early public cloud connectivity was centered around their legacy DC model, and it experienced application performance problems attributed to sub-optimal routing and high latency. Marriott had selected Equinix as their global CNF provider to help address these challenges with a goal to exit their DCs by 2025. Brenden was engaged and directed high-level design architecture for a worldwide global PoP network built around a standardized network + security stack targeted to reduce network latency and address user application experience. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Partnered with Equinix to identify 10 CNF locations across US, EMEA, APJC, and Africa to augment DC connectivity and create cloud backbone
- Presented live and virtually at multiple customer EBCs on engineering best practices and reference designs for global cloud edge architecture
- Worked with Cisco IT to understand the global CloudPort architecture footprint and integrate reference concepts into the Marriott-Equinix design
- Led network design efforts to standardize a distributed CNF network stack on VXLAN-EVPN fabrics using DCNM for automation and management
- Conducted multiple customer workshops working through regional SD WAN design and composition of distributed security stack inclusive of 3rd party
- Collaborated with CX Services to build migration and deployment plans for CNF design and integration with Equinix Cloud Exchange (ECX) services

Financial impact of Marriott global PoP architecture network wins: \$5M of DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$19M in FY18, \$15M in FY19, \$6M in FY20, \$14M in FY21, and total revenue of \$54M.

Competitive impact: Establishing Cisco as the preferred cloud networking supplier in the CNFs.

Strategic impact: Protecting DC conversions to VXLAN fabrics and laying the foundation to migrate to network as a service (NaaS).

Customer impact: Improved the user cloud application experience and readying for GPNS (Global Property Network Standards) 2.0 design.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Mayo Clinic, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$11M in FY18, \$41M in FY19, \$13M in FY20, \$9M in FY21, Total Revenue \$74M

Mayo Clinic is considered the most prestigious medical institution in the world focused on the 3 shields of clinical practice, research, and education. Located in Rochester, MN, Mayo is one of the largest medical non-profits, generating \$13.6B in annual revenues. Mayo Clinic is undergoing a major transition to a cloud-first operating model and has signed an 8-figure multi-year deal with Google. With two decades of history with Mayo, Brenden was selected to lead a Performance IT engagement to transform their enterprise network + security strategy.

Performance IT Engagement: Mayo was identified as a prospective customer for Cisco to run a Performance IT engagement. In 2015, Mayo embarked on a major network renewal effort built around introducing segmentation, but it overlooked significant domains like DC, WAN, and compute and did not consider the impact of their hybrid cloud transition. Brenden was tasked to lead an end-end re-architecture of network, security, and automation using the consumer-to-provider relationship model to build a transformation roadmap to a cloud operating model. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Lead architect for a large SME team creating to-be roadmaps across 6 distinct domains: hybrid cloud network, hybrid cloud compute, campus, WAN, security, and automation
- Directed several half-day customer whiteboard discovery workshop sessions to collect and document as-is architecture, created gap assessments, provided readouts back to customer
- Coordinated the creation of a to-be reference enterprise architecture across all 6 domains with detailed analysis of migration into brownfield network segmentation design
- Delivered several 2-3 hour to-be readout sessions to technical stakeholders and senior leadership to detail end-end architecture transformation plans and timelines
- Collaborated with CX Services to create a 48-month implementation plan and automation factory framework to drive faster outcomes aligned to the cloud operating model
- Generated a business case ROI analysis based on comprehensive bill of materials, services delivery, and retirement of assets for cost out, presented to senior leadership

Financial impact of Mayo Performance IT engagement: \$60M EN/DC product and services spread across multiple years, annual revenues of \$11M in FY18, \$41M in FY19, \$13M in FY20, \$9M in FY21, and total revenue of \$74M.

Competitive impact: Retaining current franchise domains and expanding to new domains before formal RFP processes were initiated.

Strategic impact: Instantiating a cloud transition built around CNF-focused design, stronger security, and expanded automation-orchestration.

Customer impact: Aligning and accelerating the Mayo 2030 CxO vision goals.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Medtronic, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$27M in FY18, \$16M in FY19, \$24M in FY20, \$30M in FY21, Total Revenue \$97M

Medtronic is the world's largest medical device manufacturer operating in 150+ countries and serving 72M+ patients. With corporate offices in Dublin, Ireland, Medtronic has four main portfolios 1) cardiovascular 2) medical

surgical 3) neuroscience 4) diabetes and ranks #160 on the Fortune 500 with annual revenue of \$30B. In early 2018 Medtronic tasked Cisco with creating an end-end architecture to achieve their goals to simplify operations, reduce costs, and align to cloud. Brenden was selected as the lead architect to run an IT as a Business (ITaaB) engagement.

End-to-End Enterprise Architecture: Medtronic started an official evaluation of SDN controller-based technologies in a variety of their operational domains. With a strong install base of VMware/EMC/Dell in their virtualization, storage and desktop areas, a multi-arch ELA in place, and being a reference customer for the first generation NSX product as the basis for their hybrid cloud, they were considered the frontrunner. Brenden led a team of resources from the account team, extended team, CX services, and the ITaaB team to develop an enterprise architecture plan focused on digital enablement, security, and automation. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Organized multiple customer discovery workshops to document as-is architecture, identify solution gaps, and develop use cases for brownfield and greenfield models
- Hosted 5 discreet ½ day customer workshops to ideate and whiteboard proposed to-be architectures for campus, DC/hybrid cloud, WAN, security, and automation
- Worked with IT planning/finance to build out current hardware, software, and operations cost models for as-is architecture to generate business case ROI analysis
- Developed DC/cloud architecture for 4 distinct sites running ACI fabrics in multi-site design, displaced pre-existing NSX install base and transitioned to network centric VMM integration
- Created phase-1 DC-centric SD WAN design with migration plan to distributed CoLocation model including dedicated DMZ security stacks, eliminated VeloCloud from consideration
- Built next-generation campus/branch design plan for upgraded wired connectivity and expanded wireless coverage, introduced automation and assurance capabilities

Financial impact of Medtronic end-to-end architecture wins: \$20M EN/DC product and services, annual revenues of \$27M in FY18, \$16M in FY19, \$24M in FY20, \$30M in FY21, and total revenue of \$97M.

Competitive impact: Re-established Cisco franchises in DC, EN, and WAN domains, stopped VMware/EMC/Dell spread into new adjacent domains.

Strategic impact: Strengthened Cisco's position in the account based on delivering agreed upon outcomes versus competitive vendors who had failed to achieve promised objectives.

Customer impact: Achieved stated customer IT imperatives to digitize their business, strengthen security, and introduce automation capabilities.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Nationwide Insurance, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$7M in FY18, \$21M in FY19, \$3M in FY20, and \$5M in FY21, Total Revenue \$36M

Nationwide is the 10th largest US property and casualty insurer with 2.55% market share and \$19B premiums written. Located in Columbus, OH, Nationwide is the 2nd largest writer of corporate life insurance and ranks #76 on Fortune 500 with annual revenues of \$47B. The customer was operating their two DC's using legacy fabric-based architecture which was handicapping their ability to develop a private cloud architecture. Brenden was enlisted in early 2018 to lead design and architecture for multi-site DCs, data center interconnect, and workload mobility.

Multi-Site Fabricpath DC Migration – Nationwide originally elected to deploy a Layer-2 Fabricpath based overlay network with OTV for data center interconnect, but had identified gaps in the solution around standardization, automation, and absence of routed layer-3 transport. Customer was a long-standing VMware client and planned to evaluate software based NSX and hardware-based Arista in addition to Cisco options. Brenden led design and architecture assessment of both solutions selecting NX-OS based BGP-EVPN and worked through building a detailed migration plan. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Arranged several ½ day whiteboard education and design sessions with the customer to train them on SDN dis-aggregation, 2-tier fabric design, and VXLAN overlay technology

- Developed multi-site architecture design options for both standalone NX-OS based fabric and ACI fabric with brownfield integration to production Fabricpath network
- Collaborated with customer and partner to map out and prioritize use cases, created detailed competitive test plan to be utilized in bake-off between Arista, VMware, and Cisco
- Constructed detailed migration plan to non-disruptively introduce VXLAN fabric with Fabricpath interop to migrate workloads until Fabricpath was evacuated and could be retired
- Re-designed private cloud network + compute stack to leverage VXLAN multi-site architecture to facilitate workload mobility, expanded automation to improve provisioning times
- Provided future state design to introduce SD WAN and shift from DC-centric model to cloud-centric model built around distributed CoLocation facilities for optimized application access

Financial impact of Nationwide Fabricpath DC migration win: \$5M in DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$7M in FY18, \$21M in FY19, \$3M in FY20, \$5M in FY21, and total revenue of \$36M.

Competitive impact: Winning key bake-offs against Arista to keep them out of the account and VMware to prevent them from expanding into the networking space.

Strategic impact: Re-established Cisco as primary networking vendor and opened door for SD WAN rollout and investment in distributed CoLocation cloud-centric design.

Customer impact: Achieved stated objectives to migrate to standards based VXLAN overlay and enabled successful buildout of private cloud infrastructure stack.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Progressive Insurance, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$21M in FY18, \$79M in FY19, \$38M in FY20, \$48M in FY21, Total Revenue \$186M

Progressive is the 3rd largest property and casualty insurer in the US, with 5.75% market share and \$42B premiums written. Based in Cleveland, OH, Progressive is the #1 commercial auto insurer and ranks #74 on the Fortune 500 with annual revenues of \$48B. The customer had been operating their two DCs in an active-standby arrangement with their second site acting as a cold standby DR location. Brenden was engaged in early 2018 leading design and architecture for a customer RFP to enable virtualized active-active DCs.

Metro Virtual Data Center (MVDC): Progressive issued a formal RFP for MVDC in late 2017. The project was awarded to Dell/EMC, given the primary focus was on the IBM mainframe complex, but Cisco won all the network business. One of the most challenging aspects of responding to the RFP requirements was the stipulation for active-active DCs with an expectation of 99.999% availability. Brenden led Cisco's team of resources to complete the customer RFP response, including creation of a brownfield network design in close partnership with Dell/EMC and CX Services. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Conducted multiple onsite whiteboard ideation sessions with the customer to review best practices for high availability multi-DC design for network, compute, and storage
- Constructed a large-scale ACI MultiSite design with 80 leaf switches in Bunker East and Metro DCs, and re-architected a high-speed core backbone DC interconnect network
- Partnered with Dell/EMC and CX Services to redesign IBM mainframe routed network and create a non-disruptive migration schedule for virtualized workloads
- Documented customer user cases, created test plan scenarios, and accompanied the customer for a full week of onsite SVS testing high availability and failover
- Arranged with IBNG leadership for Progressive to be added to the Customer Advisory Board (CAB), and hosted the customer in San Jose on multiple CAB meetings
- Worked with the customer to restructure Internet routing and DMZ security for introduction of a carrier-neutral facility and hybrid cloud connectivity

Financial impact of Progressive MVDC project wins: \$30M of DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$21M in FY18, \$79M in FY19, \$38M in FY20, \$48M in FY21, and total revenue of \$186M.

Competitive impact: Keeping VMware NSX from gaining any significant footprint in the Progressive DCs.

Strategic impact: Creating a reference customer for large-scale multi data center ACI deployment in the financial services sector.

Customer impact: Tackling CIO directive for improved business continuance, high availability, and disaster recovery services, resulting in improved application accessibility.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

UnitedHealth Group (UHG), 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$86M in FY18, \$68M in FY19, \$48 in FY20, \$75M in FY21, Total Revenue \$277M

UHG is the largest US healthcare insurer, with 49.5M members and partnerships with 1.3M physicians and 6,500 hospitals. Headquartered in Minnetonka, MN, UHG ranks #5 on the Fortune 500, generating \$257B in annual revenue with \$143B coming from health services division Optum. UHG's data centers were built around traditional 3-tier architecture and needed to be upgraded to fabric-based leaf spine technology. Having worked on UHG since 2004, Brenden led efforts to establish the SDN data center franchise from 2018 to 2022.

Software Defined Data Center: In early 2018, UHG issued a formal RFP for DC refresh to an SDN-enabled fabric architecture. Cisco's primary competition was VMware, Arista, Big Switch, Juniper, and HP/Aruba. Subsequent RFPs in 2019-2021 were also released for non-SDN data center switching and Cloud Integration Hubs (CIH), with Arista acting as primary adversary. Brenden took a primary leadership role in Cisco's response to all these RFPs, guiding design and architecture to address UHG's mandate to build 100% zero touch fabrics leveraging DevOps. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Coordinated RFP responses, created RFP presentation materials, and delivered official RFP presentations to UHG mid- and senior-level leadership
- Positioned and designed large-scale independent ACI fabrics for Optum Tech and Optum Care, which have now grown to an aggregate of 500 leaf switches
- Worked with BE engineering leadership to expand ACI features to support Kubernetes CNI plugin (Canal), integrated NAT/LB services, and NSX VMM integration
- Made the case for UHG to be added to the INSBU Customer Advisory Board (CAB), hosted the customer at multiple CAB meetings, and set up a 1:1 engineering exchange
- Created Cloud Integration Hub (CIH) switching and routing design, built with advanced capabilities for service redirection and service chaining
- UHG is a Viptela SD WAN and ISE-TrustSec customer, partnered with engineering to help scope requirements for SD WAN to ACI pairwise integration

Financial impact of multiple UnitedHealth Group DC/CIH wins: \$15M in DC/Cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$86M in FY18, \$68M in FY19, \$48M in FY20, \$75M in FY21, and total revenue of \$277M.

Competitive impact: Repetitive wins against VMware and Arista to remain incumbent vendor in SDN, non-SDN, and CIH core platforms.

Strategic impact: The creation of reference architecture for ACI and NSX co-existence; ACI providing networking, NSX offering security.

Customer impact: Achieved a fully automated hybrid cloud networking + security stack.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

US Bank, 2018 – Present

Revenue Impact: \$42M in FY18, \$95M in FY19, \$35M in FY20, \$20M in FY21, Total Revenue \$192M

US Bank is the 5th largest bank in the US, with ~3,000 branches, ~4,800 ATMs, and they own Elavon, which is one of the largest credit card transaction processors. With corporate offices in Minneapolis, MN, US Bank has \$475B in assets and ranks #113 on Fortune 500 with \$25B in annual revenue. Under Brenden's direction, US Bank built a

dual active DC design for Olathe, KS and Chaska, MN sites in 2017. When the company needed to move to a “cloud first” operational model, Brenden was engaged from 2018 to 2022 to lead DC transformation to multicloud access.

Multi Data Center High Availability: US Bank had completed a successful ACI pilot rollout in Chaska, MN. With plans to expand SDN fabrics to Energy Park and Olathe DCs, evaluation was ongoing between ACI and VMware NSX-T and VMware Cloud Foundation (VCF). Also under consideration was distributed DC connectivity utilizing carrier neutral facilities (CNF). Brenden directed a multi-year SDN expansion in the private DCs, designed the addition of multiple CNFs, and planned their transition to a public cloud modeled multi-AZ high availability architecture. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Conducted multiple in-depth training sessions for the customer on advanced ACI design, to include MultiPod, MultiSite, Remote Leaf, and Cloud ACI
- Expanded ACI to a tiered design running MultiPod between Chaska and Energy Park DCs and MultiSite between Olathe and Chaska DCs (300 leaf switches)
- Created a full multi-DC segmentation plan with network-centric mode ACI providing macro-segmentation and Cisco Secure Workload providing micro-segmentation
- Partnered with Equinix to host multiple customer workshops to build a framework for a distributed CNF design leveraging multi-vendor network + security stack
- Generated a hybrid multicloud architecture for ACI Anywhere with integration into AWS, Azure utilizing Direct Connect and Express Route
- Refactored multi-DC design to introduce higher levels of isolation, availability, and resiliency, utilizing public cloud benchmark for multi availability zone (AZ)

Financial impact of US Bank multi-DC high availability design expansion: \$25M in DC/cloud product and services, annual revenues of \$42M in FY18, \$95M in FY19, \$35M in FY20, \$20M in FY21, and total revenue of \$192M.

Competitive impact: Preserved Cisco as primary incumbent DC partner, keeping VMware limited to the server virtualization/cloud domain.

Strategic impact: The creation of re-usable reference architecture for multi-availability zone DC design.

Customer impact: A successful transition to a hybrid cloud model with improved network uptime.

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Cisco EN&C Ideas Portal, 2020 – Present

Revenue Impact: This new tool streamlines the ability to provide input on product development and new features. As development priorities will be more easily established, it will speed up time to market for new offerings and directly affect revenue.

Cisco has always recognized the importance of customers and the internal field providing input to BE teams on new product development and the addition of new features on existing products. Historically, this has been a disjointed process with no standardized tool utilized uniformly across the BE teams, resulting in many ad hoc efforts by individuals, account teams, and customers trying to drive development priorities. To address this issue Cisco has introduced the Cisco EN&C Ideas Portal, also known as the AHA tool. Brenden was approached by senior leadership from DC field teams to lead the Day-2 Operations team and to join the ACI team. Brenden's involvement and accomplishments include:

- Team leader for Day-2 Operations Team responsible for Nexus Dashboard (ND), Nexus Dashboard Orchestrator (NDO), Nexus Dashboard Insights (NDI), and Nexus Dashboard Data Broker (NDDDB)
- Conducted monthly team meetings to review Day-2 Operations submissions, provided feedback on viability to implement, and prioritized them for BU consideration
- Coordinated monthly meetings with BE product management and engineering teams to review list of submissions, review resource requirements, and assign roadmap priorities
- Arranged quarterly BE interlock summarizing top 6-8 AHA submissions, presented to senior DCN leadership to drive roadmap commitments and timeframes

- Team contributor for 8-member ACI team responsible for covering ACI fabric, Cloud ACI, and Nexus Dashboard Orchestrator (jointly with Day-2 Operations)
- Organized and classified ACI submissions into prioritized groupings, presented top 10 ideas, and drove BE commitment and resource assignment

Brenden was amongst the first field resources identified to support the Cisco EN&C Ideas Portal initiative. His leadership for the Day-2 Operations team had a global impact on product direction and feature prioritization for the entire ND portfolio, which was at an important juncture having just reached first customer shipment. He pushed the BE to transition ND to a SaaS platform as the top priority to ensure market alignment and drive higher adoption. As a result of his efforts driving cross-domain ND strategy, the BE developed a broader set of platform integrations like ThousandEyes, Intersight, AppD, and SD WAN. In his role on the ACI team, Brenden also had global impact on a more mature product by redirecting focus to cloud ACI integrations, SaaS enablement, SD WAN connectivity for public cloud extension, and capability enhancements to close competitive gaps with Arista, VMware, and Aviatrix.

SASE Go-to-Market Strategy, 2020 – Present

Revenue Impact: This GTM strategy is having a global impact with all front-line AM/SE teams, the GSSO teams, and the SASE specialist teams and will improve revenue projections as it becomes mainstream. It also is directly affecting how we align staffing and subject matter expertise to ensure Cisco captures market share.

One of Cisco's top priorities is taking an industry-leading position in the SASE market. SASE architecture combines Network-as-a-Service (NaaS) and Network Security-as-a-Service (SECaaS) into a single cloud-delivered SaaS platform. Accordingly, SASE threatens large portions of Cisco's Enterprise Networking and Security portfolios — highlighting the importance of this objective. Cisco entered the SASE market late and is taking measures to close the gap with Zscaler and other market competitors. In most early SASE sales engagements, Cisco competed head-to-head, focused on individual technical capabilities, and was regularly losing deals. To combat this, a new field-driven SASE go-to-market strategy was devised to better address Cisco's shortcomings and improve deal winning percentage. Brenden was one of the leaders who designed and helped implement this sales strategy. His activities and accomplishments include:

- Collaborated to create a new high-level sales campaign leveraging 4 pillars: Reduced Cost, Speed to Market, Improved User Experience, and Minimized Risk
- Participates on the SASE Technical Go-to-Market team responsible for SASE engagement strategy, SASE enablement, SASE content, SASE demos and labs, and competitive intelligence
- Content creator and contributor to SASE BDM and TDM decks that are updated quarterly, and the co-lead for the SD WAN and Software Defined Cloud Interconnect (SDCI) sections
- Member of the SASE Workshop 2.0 Working Group working on latest dCloud educational demos and workflows, and an ongoing dCloud demo reviewer on Moodle platform
- Invited by direct account and/or extended account teams to deliver virtual EBC or virtual workshop and training sessions for SASE for ~12 GES opportunities
- Requested by Cisco's SASE RFP team and direct account teams to participate in creating customer SASE RFP responses for ~12 GES opportunities

Brenden led a handful of the earliest sales opportunities where a "Northstar" design was created and the new sales engagement strategy was employed. Feedback indicated Cisco was advancing much further into the sales process and achieving higher success rates. Hence, the new process is being incorporated into all sales and technical collateral and the field is being trained on the new sales motion. This is having global impact with all front-line AM/SE teams, the GSSO teams, and the SASE specialist teams and will improve revenue projections as it becomes mainstream. It also is directly affecting how we align staffing and subject matter expertise to ensure Cisco captures market share.

Worldwide SASE Training, 2020 – 2021

Revenue Impact: A much stronger level of sales engagement and forecasted deal pipeline for SASE will directly impact revenue.

SASE represents a new systems architecture that converges networking and security into a cloud-enabled SaaS platform. In too many instances, Cisco was not identifying SASE sales opportunities and was competing for individual components rather than the end-end platform architecture. Also, there was a lack of knowledge transfer on up-to-date competitive intelligence, which was causing systemic losses in sales engagements. Historically, Cisco has struggled in three related areas:

- Integrating multidomain architectures that span across BE boundaries
- Redundant platform development initiatives
- Delivering solutions as SaaS platforms

With these challenges in mind, SASE field training was deemed a high priority action item by the SASE SWAT Team. Brenden took on the primary leadership role to get training developed, organized, and delivered across all Worldwide Sales. His accomplishments include:

- Designed and created SASE SE training outline, and worked with SASE SWAT team coordinator Iftach Socher to coordinate and schedule 5x90 minute sessions
- Identified speakers and Q&A panelists, planned training curriculum, created training collateral, and worked with the team to build supporting demos (live and pre-recorded)
- Arranged dry-run training sessions presented to senior sales and sales engineering leadership audiences for GES East, GES West, GES Central, GES South and USPS
- Worked with senior geo-leaders for session sponsorship: Eric Knipp – Americas, Koen Jacobs – EMEAR, Raymond Janse van Rensburg – APJC, Shelly Blackburn – GSSO
 - Americas – 10/27/20, 1,786 attendees, session score 4.86
 - EMEAR #1 – 10/28/20, 679 attendees, session score 4.58
 - APJC – 10/29/20, 280 attendees, session score 4.84
 - EMEAR #2 – 11/17/20, 436 attendees, session score 4.75
 - Americas Partner Community – 02/02/21, 500 attendees

Brenden made a global impact through planning and arranging the delivery of SASE training to the Worldwide Sales organization across all Cisco's main geographies inclusive of Americas, EMEA, APJC, and the extended Partner Community. This resulted in ~3,500 field resources participating and successfully completing training with an average survey score of 4.76. This also spawned the creation of the SASE Technical Go-to-Market team, the SASE Tiger Team, and the SASE Workshop 2.0 Working Group, which later delivered a 6x30 mins session training series as direct follow-up. This has resulted in a much stronger sales engagement and forecasted deal pipeline for SASE.

Competitive Intelligence, 2012 – Present

Revenue Impact: Trainings designed specifically to target how to win deals over primary competitors VMware, Arista, and Zscaler have, and will continue to have, a major impact on revenue.

This is a specialty Brenden has focused on and made substantial contributions to since moving into overlay roles almost two decades ago. In the past, Cisco had BE-specific resources to track competitive vendors in their respective areas, but that has been scaled back and centralized. In the absence of those distributed resources, much of the burden for competitive information had become a field-led function working in tandem with Stef Eller's centralized team. Brenden's PA nomination package detailed his work leading the VMware NSX team and co-leading the Arista competitive team. That work has continued to the present time, and he has added similar efforts for Zscaler.

Competitive Intelligence, Zscaler, 2019 - Present

Zscaler is Cisco's primary competitor in cloud security opportunities. With SASE encompassing Network-as-a-Service (NaaS) and Network Security-as-a-Service (SECaaS) in a single platform, that's expanded the threat to Cisco's business to include VPN, remote work, SD WAN, and Zero Trust. Zscaler's main messages have been

“networking does not matter” and “network security will be obsolete,” contradicting Cisco’s viewpoint. Brenden has been instrumental in evaluating the Zscaler competitive risks and designating them in the tier-1 category to bring more focus to these efforts. He’s also been a field leader addressing Zscaler competitive issues from the onset of the SASE market. His involvement and accomplishments include:

- Developed worldwide SE SASE training, collaborated to create curriculum and collateral, arranged speakers, and delivered multiple sessions to US, EMEA, APJC, and partners
- Partnered with Mike Storm’s security competitive intelligence team to provide updates on Zscaler sales engagement activities for integration into collateral posted on Klue
- Part of the field team that organized the SE SASE Webinar Series, built the prospectus and content, presented multiple sessions, and participated as Q&A panelist for all sessions
- Worked with PA Anthony Sabella to create the new SASE sales motion focused on high-level messaging, and implemented strategy on multiple accounts with improved results
- Condensed Zscaler competitive SASE content, and delivered 2-part 60-minute sessions in support of Enterprise Area SE Enablement training (also Palo Alto Prisma)

Competitive Intelligence, VMware, 2012 - Present

VMware is Cisco’s primary competitor in hybrid cloud network, server, and storage infrastructure opportunities. Cisco grades competitors depending on threat severity, with tier-1 being the highest designation. Brenden performed a pivotal role in capturing customer and internal field data to make a case to promote VMware to a tier-1 competitor. This was based on VMware infringing into more areas of the Cisco portfolio, including virtualized infrastructure, hybrid cloud, SD WAN, enterprise security, etc. The VMware tier-1 categorization was key because it meant more resources and funding were directed to competitive efforts and, in this instance, that resulted in the Voltron project being created. Brenden’s involvement and accomplishments include:

- Interviewed by Cisco competitive team ~6 different times to capture field lessons learned, which were integrated into newly created internal competitive collateral
- Worked directly with the Voltron team to re-shape the sales motion playbook against VMware to focus on a platform approach featuring automation, applications, and observability
- Part of the core team that built VMware Blackbelt training curriculum, created and reviewed collateral, and presented multiple training modules at VMware Blackbelt bootcamps
- Collapsed VMware Blackbelt bootcamp training into ~2 hours of collateral, presented training materials to Area (2) and Operations (2) AM/SE/Specialist teams
- DC-SEVT track owner for ACI for multiple years, integrated Voltron training curriculum into bi-annual VT events, and is a repeat session owner and session presenter
- Volunteered for Virtual Training Immersive Experience (VTIE) and collaborated with PA Carlos Campos Torres to record the live 90-minute Lightboard Video training session, “Extending ACI to Multi-DC and Hybrid Cloud Environments” (10/15/19)

Competitive Intelligence, Arista, 2012 – Present

Arista is Cisco’s primary competitor in next-generation scale-out DC switching opportunities. Arista has been identified as a tier-1 competitor and that has intensified with recent acquisitions like Metamako which expanded their portfolio to ultra-low latency switching and Mojo Networks which gave them cloud-based wireless technology. With Arista’s expansion into campus wired and wireless networking as well as merchant routing platforms, Brenden was amongst the first field resources to start capturing updated information and was directly responsible for helping create an expanded set of competitive collateral inclusive of DC, campus, core, and edge services routing products. His involvement and accomplishments include:

- Interviewed by Cisco competitive team on ~4 different occasions to capture early field engagement data, which resulted in newly created internal competitive collateral
- Part of the core team that designed the Arista Blackbelt training curriculum, produced and reviewed collateral, and presented multiple training modules at Arista Blackbelt bootcamps

- Condensed the Arista Blackbelt bootcamp training into ~2 hours of collateral and presented training materials to Area (2) and Operations (2) AM/SE/Specialist teams
- DC-SEVT track owner for ACI for multiple years, integrated the Arista training curriculum into bi-annual VT events, and is a repeat session owner and session presenter
- Volunteered for Virtual Training Immersive Experience (VTIE) and collaborated with multiple colleagues to record a live 60-minute Lightboard Video training session, “Arista DASH Competitive Immersive Experience 3 Live!” (01/14/20)

Brenden’s sustained competitive efforts focused on VMware, Arista, and Zscaler have had global impact on Cisco product management and engineering across platform development, feature delivery, and roadmap priorities. He has impacted go-to-market plans and competitive sales engagement for these competitors by consistently generating and updating field collateral. He has been at the forefront, driving training initiatives for the worldwide sales organization developing VMware Blackbelt, Arista Blackbelt, and Worldwide SASE curriculum, including acting as a presenter and Q&A manager. Brenden has led competitive education efforts for the DC virtual teams, partnered with INSBU to update competitive VMware and Arista collateral, and presented at BE-sponsored competitive training sessions. He has also regularly presented Cisco’s SASE technology story in virtual EBCs and in support of SASE RFPs.

SASE SWAT Team, 2020 – Present

VP of Global Systems Engineering Tim Carnes and Cisco Fellow and Chief Architect Matt Gillies sponsor a small number of field SWAT teams focused on Cisco’s highest priority technology initiatives. Team composition is primarily PA and DA members with focus on horizon-2 and horizon-3 priorities. Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) was one of the first key areas identified where a team was created, and Brenden was selected as an original member ~2 years ago. The team meets regularly and is chartered to track a set of workstreams that Brenden has either led individually, co-led as part of smaller teams, or contributed to as part of the larger group. Brenden's engagement and accomplishments include:

- Collected and documented customer and field requirements for GES/USPS segments for Cisco+ Secure Connect (Frontizo) and Cisco+ Secure Connect Choice (CSMRA) platforms
- Organized and prioritized gap analysis with GES/USPS field recommendations for Cisco+ Secure Connect and Cisco+ Secure Connect Choice, and presented to BE leadership teams
- Designed primary SASE use cases with core elements and detailed technical walk-thru of “Connect, Control, and Converge” for Secure Remote Worker and Secure Edge
- Created customer and field requirements given to BE leadership for common identity, IoT, unified endpoint client, and centralized single UI/dashboard
- Planned and delivered Worldwide SE training for SASE across Americas, EMEA, APJC theaters and Partner Community for ~3,500 total participants
- Prepared both technical and business collateral for various readouts to BE groups, senior management, and ELT leadership, and has been a speaker on presentation teams delivering sessions to leadership

Brenden’s leadership, influence, and contributions as part of the SASE SWAT Team and related initiatives have impacted Cisco’s strategy, product development, and go-to-market efforts on a global basis. Working directly with the BE engineering and product management teams for Cisco+ Secure Connect and Cisco+ Secure Connect Choice, this has directly impacted roadmap and delivery timeframes, feature and capability prioritizations, and scalability improvements for large GES and USPS customers. It has also raised awareness of competitive gaps that need to be addressed for Cisco to succeed in the SASE market, including identity management, Zero Trust services, unified client, single user interface, co-location services, and a plan to merge multiple solutions into a single platform. Brenden has led and participated in all the field enablement efforts around SASE to jumpstart Cisco sales motions in this sector, and his broad efforts to engage with customers in a variety of ways has brought tremendous insight on the competitive landscape and the use cases Cisco’s SASE platform needs to address to gain broad adoption.

MDO SWAT Team, 2020 – Present

Multidomain Orchestration (MDO) was another essential area identified where a SWAT Team was created, and Brenden was selected as an original member ~2 years ago. The team meets regularly and is chartered to track a set of workstreams that Brenden has either led individually, co-led as part of smaller teams, or contributed to as part of the larger group. His engagement and accomplishments include:

- Captured customer requirements, documented use cases, and gathered competitive information to scope the business case for an MDO platform that would align to Cisco's broader domain controller strategy
- Performed portfolio gap analysis on available MDO platforms that included alternatives to build on pre-existing, create from the ground-up, or acquire technology, and then made his MDO platform recommendation
- Worked directly with BE product management, engineering, and senior field leadership to create GES and USPS go-to-market strategy for MDO, and drove roadmap requirements and priorities for the MDO platform
- Contributed to MSX collateral creation of BDM and TDM decks, delivered a multitude of training sessions on GES All-Hands, Area All-Hands, Operations Teams, CX Teams, and the vCTO Team
- Directly involved in ~20 MDO customer EFT engagements, partnered with BE and CX resources to drive customer adoption, and designed proposed MDO architectures with use cases
- Prepared both technical and business collateral for various readouts to BE groups, senior management, and ELT leadership, and is a speaker on presentation teams delivering sessions to leadership

Currently, Cisco does not have an established architecture with roadmap plans for multidomain orchestration. Brenden's leadership, influence, and contributions on the MDO SWAT Team have guided Cisco's strategy, platform investments, and go-to-market plans globally. He has been instrumental in identifying solution gaps in Cisco's platforms and creating a problem statement outlining details of portfolio shortcomings. He also drove technical requirements and use cases to facilitate creating a business case for a Cisco MDO platform. Brenden has been a field leader building MDO customer messaging and working to drive customer interest and engagements for early platform adoption. Additionally, he has worked closely with the BE teams to outline plans to support large-scale GES and USPS customers by expanding feature capabilities, and he has supported use cases on the MDO platform. Brenden has been extremely active in supporting MDO training enablement efforts for the field and CX services teams. These contributions are shaping Cisco's platform plans and helping Cisco retain an industry-leading competitive position.

Meraki GES Go-to-Market Strategy, 2020 – 2021

Meraki has been a very successful Cisco platform, but historically has been more aligned to small and mid-market Commercial customers. With the industry shifts to cloud-native platforms and SaaS consumption, the Meraki platform has growing relevancy to large GES and USPS customers. Cisco is taking strategic steps to increase scalability of the Meraki platform and align campus wired + wireless switching products to Meraki cloud management. To align with this strategic direction, Central Area leadership took steps to get the field teams trained and empowered to position Meraki more broadly. Brenden was requested to co-lead this initiative. His leadership activities and accomplishments include:

- Set up and scheduled bi-weekly interlocks between Central Area Pursuit Team and Meraki field sales and engineering to review product updates and drive GES sales engagements
- Attended multiple Meraki continuing education training classes and bi-weekly Meraki training sessions to gain a more in-depth understanding of Meraki technology to GES customers
- Developed a training outline and curriculum for Meraki field enablement, and co-delivered multiple sessions to Central Area AM/SE/PSS/TSA and leadership as part of a continuing education series
- Led a multitude of large-scale Meraki GES sales engagements, including Humana branch-in-a-box, State Farm next-generation branch, and Accenture next-generation digital office
- Worked with the Project Aurora team to identify and interview customers interested in Catalyst switching with Meraki dashboard, including Stryker, Proctor & Gamble, Humana/Kindred Healthcare, and Accenture

- Managed SASE competitive opportunities where Cisco+ Secure Connect was being positioned pre-FCS in GES accounts for alignment, scalability, roadmap timing, and EFT accessibility

Brenden's contributions and leadership driving the Meraki GES go-to-market strategy has made significant global impact both internally and with customers. First and foremost, driving more GES- and USPS-focused Meraki sales campaigns has expanded Meraki's range and increased revenue in these respective segments with 300% year over year growth. Expanding Meraki to more GES and USPS accounts required greater platform scale and feature development velocity, which directly impacted product management and engineering commitments. Building training collateral to drive field enablement pushed GES and USPS account teams to position Meraki more regularly, which expanded market penetration and further increased revenues. Brenden was directly involved in several very early, significant deals and continues to work on large-scale strategic Meraki opportunities, leading by example to guide the broader field teams. He has been influential in the emerging SASE market, where Cisco is facing strong competition, helping drive engineering and product management roadmaps for Cisco+ Secure Connect as it scales to meet GES and USPS requirements.

Performance IT Lead, 2018 – 2021

Historically, Cisco has built sales engagements on an individual customer project basis and closed deals by selling on technical attributes of the products, and this model has proven successful. However, it has also resulted in a transaction-oriented sales structure and limited the ability to expand the scope of opportunities for end-end architecture. To address these limitations, Cisco created Performance IT, which asserts a business- and ROI-led approach of strengthening technical architecture with the objective to drive larger deals and create trusted advisor relationships with customers. Brenden was one of the first Area field leads supporting the Performance IT practice. His activities and accomplishments include:

- Attended three different in-person Performance IT field practice lead training classes designed to jumpstart customer engagements and establish business value selling architecture
- Collaborated with other practice leads to create customer screening criteria and eligibility requirements for Performance IT engagements – centrally led (SET) and account led
- Partnered with the Performance IT team to generate cross-domain architecture best practices collateral for data center, hybrid cloud, campus, SD WAN, security, and automation
- Organized and created the training outline and curriculum for broad field enablement, and jointly delivered two in-person training classes for area/operations AM/SE/PSS/TSA and leadership audiences
- Acted as the main technical architecture lead for Performance IT customer engagements for Medtronic, T. Rowe Price, Navy Federal Credit Union, Mayo Clinic, Silicon Valley Bank, and Johnson Controls (JCI)
- Assisted with company transition from Performance IT practice to Business Value Architecture (BVA) model, which included an updated engagement model and refreshed architecture collateral

Brenden's role as one of the first Area-level Performance IT practice leads has impacted how Cisco engages with customers globally. He was amongst the first field resources trained on the Performance IT model and turned around and designed and delivered training to the broader field to drive enablement and establish best practices. He was also instrumental in creating the decision tree process for how to successfully identify prospective Performance IT customers for both centrally led and account led engagement models. Brenden drove development of reference architectures in data center, hybrid cloud, and security and, even more importantly, constructed how cross-domain architecture is designed and implemented leveraging automation and orchestration. Combining these broader contributions and the specific engagements he supported, Brenden was responsible for driving hundreds of millions of dollars in direct revenue. Cisco wanted to broaden Performance IT to more GES and USPS customers starting in FY2021, so Brenden helped transition and map Performance IT to Business Value Architecture, which has markedly increased pipeline revenue.

Pairwise Integrations/Multidomain Policy, 2018 – Present

Cisco BEs are responsible for product design and engineering of solutions to address targeted use cases for those individual domains. This model works well for each domain, but it poses challenges when multiple domains are

deployed and cross-architecture integration is required. To address customer requirements, Cisco initiated a project to build pairwise integrations between DC, EN, and SD WAN domains with a multidomain policy application to distribute end-end policy across domains. Brenden was one of a few field advisors who worked directly with customers and BEs to get these capabilities delivered to market. His involvement and accomplishments include:

- Collaborated with DA David Jansen and PA Cesar Obediente to outline the original problem statement and customer requirements for cross-domain architecture
- Partnered with DCG and ENB to scope customer integration requirements between ACI in the DC domain, DNA-C in the campus domain, and Viptela vManage in the WAN domain (v1.0)
- Worked directly with engineering to contribute customer and field requirements for building multidomain policy (MDP) application framework and workflows
- Created multiple revisions of pairwise integration and multidomain policy collateral intended for field consumption, and presented on multiple operations and Area All-Hands
- Organized multiple DC-SEVT sessions on pairwise integration and multidomain policy, including planning for Cisco Fellows Tom Edsall and Rex Fernando to present
- Provided input on roadmap plans and functional specs for pairwise integrations v2.0 and v3.0, designed to achieve higher scale and improved performance

For a variety of reasons, the pairwise integrations and multidomain policy engineering work did not move forward as originally intended. The v1.0 pairwise integration design suffered from scalability issues and was incomplete with group and identity information exchanged, but no policy capabilities. Pairwise integration v2.0 ran into engineering code issues and was too difficult to deploy without a common orchestration tool and was cancelled. The MDP application leveraged proprietary adapters and was dependent on DNA-C hosting and was also abandoned. Many positive outcomes were realized from these efforts, however. Capturing customer use cases, Brenden and the team discovered a real need in Cisco's portfolio and initiated the MDO efforts that are now driven by the SWAT team. The v3.0 pairwise integration in development has much more complete requirements for scale and now includes policy exchange for multiple use cases. Additionally, a top-level orchestration tool leveraging published APIs is being considered to simplify deployment and support a much broader set of managed platforms.

Innovation

Brenden has demonstrated a strong commitment to leading complex customer engagements and creating innovative solutions to solve customer problems. The first step in this process typically begins with understanding and documenting the customer use case and related problems they are trying to solve. Brenden has proven very capable of achieving this in a wide spectrum of customer scenarios spanning a variety of industry verticals and ranging across many technology disciplines.

He has shown he can attack problems in two distinct ways:

- Constructing unique design architectures using pre-existing products and integrating them into a solution
- Driving new development to create a solution

A couple examples occurred with customers looking to modernize next-generation remote office architectures to support initiatives like fully orchestrated touchless deployment, full as-a-service solution deployment, and enablement for new customer-facing applications. In another pair of examples, solutions were custom built that addressed creation of a hybrid cloud utility model and design of a discovery tool to address policy deployment. Both solutions advanced and were developed further and are now offered as mainstream products in the Cisco+ and campus analytics portfolios with large potential TAMs.

In a final example, a customer and Cisco partnered to jointly architect a remote IoT management solution to address one of the high-growth, strategic investment areas for the company. The innovation Brenden led has

driven booked and pipeline revenue totaling \$225M and brought products to market with \$250M in booked and pipeline revenue. He has established a strong track record of generating innovation ideas and has built trust internally with the BEs to support his efforts.

Brenden has an extraordinary commitment to innovation in pursuit of solving customer problems. Several examples are below.

Next Generation Cloud Networking, January 2022 – Present

Customer Problem: A growing balance of customers are building their next generation of applications running on public cloud infrastructure. Accordingly, providing more native cloud networking capabilities is on the rise and the needs for more advanced features with higher performance is following suit. Today, one of the solutions Cisco builds for cloud networking is Cloud OnRamp (CoR) for IaaS using Viptela SD WAN as the network fabric transport. The CoR solution is designed to integrate with each individual public cloud providers networking stack of choice – TGW for AWS, vWAN Hub for Azure, and GCR for Google. This results in a unique operational model for each cloud provider causing a high degree of complexity and slow time to market provisioning. A growing list of competitors like Aviatrix and Alkira are building their own cloud gateways with no dependency on the public cloud provider's networking stack which results in a uniform operations model and faster deployment timeframes. To remain competitively viable, Cisco needs to re-architect the CoR solution to provide comparable cloud native networking.

Customer solution: Working with a small core team of engineers from the PA/DA team, we have developed a proposed re-architecture of the CoR model. First, the recommendation maintains the current virtual SD WAN router (Cat8Kv) needs to be refactored from a VM based model to a cloud native container-based approach. This will dramatically improve boot times, decrease performance overhead, and enable auto-scaling to provide dynamic scale out capabilities. Second, the architecture asserts extending the SD WAN fabric further into the cloud provider by providing native gateways in the customer VPC's removing the need for each provider's proprietary networking. Doing this would normalize networking to the same operational model across each of the cloud providers enabling consistent routing, segmentation, and policy control. Next, the solution changes how automation is deployed to leverage Terraform, the most widely used cloud provisioning tool. Finally, this design will result in increased Cat8Kv instances which will raise the customer cost, so a change to the pricing model to remain competitive is needed.

Business impact: Re-designing the CoR architecture to cloud native networking will enable Cisco to capture the strategic cloud backbone control point, reduce dependency on cloud providers, and move past key competitors.

Mastercard Full Stack Observability, September 2021 - Present

Customer Problem: Mastercard is a customer that does a lot of their own custom application development. Many of the applications are customer facing, making user experience a top priority as it directly impacts their brand. They have invested tremendously in monitoring tools from many vendors attempting to observe application performance but complained about the abundance of tools and the absence of end-end application visibility. Mastercard contacted Cisco about their interest in full stack observability; however, they wanted a broader scope to include network edge, network access, integrated security, external configuration automation, and end-to-end multi domain orchestration.

Customer solution: Leading a collection of Cisco account and CX team resources, Brenden created an end-end FSO design from network access (consumer) to workload/application (provider). The logical flow was DNA-C edge => SD WAN access => SASE => Intersight => Application. The workload configuration was automated externally from the Intersight Terraform provider. MSX supplied multidomain orchestration across multi-cluster DNA-C, multi-fabric SD WAN, and Umbrella SIG. Most importantly, MSX automated push of ThousandEyes and AppD agents integrated with Intersight/IWO to complete the FSO stack, simplifying tooling and enhancing operations.

Business Impact: The full stack observability project taught us valuable lessons how to take a customer use case from idea to a functional customer demo, which has resulted in forecasted product and services revenue of \$5M.

State Farm Agent Office of the Future, August 2021 - Present

Customer Problem: State Farm has a very large WAN with ~18,000 remote agent office locations. They had three distinct SD WAN solutions deployed in addition to legacy sites still running traditional non-fabric WAN. They also had a mixed voice environment, with Cisco providing telephony services and Microsoft supplying the collaboration services. This created an increasingly difficult environment to operationalize, secure, monitor, and manage. State

Farm approached Cisco about building an end-end agent office of the future with data, voice, video services, and native cloud security — all deployed with full zero-touch automation and multidomain orchestration.

Customer Solution: Leading a large group of Cisco account and BVA team resources, Brenden developed a next-generation agent office architecture focused on delivering interactive collaboration applications, offering competitive differentiation. The design leverages a full Meraki stack with wired, wireless, SD WAN, and physical security for touchless installs and direct equipment shipping. MSX is leveraged to manage brownfield Viptela SD WAN and multi-organization Meraki SD WAN. The centerpiece of the architecture is a prototype application workflow utilizing weather alerts to trigger insurance claim creation with Webex calling, Contact Center Enterprise, and IMI Mobile.

Business Impact: The State Farm agent office of the future signifies the opportunity to displace three competitive franchises in Velocloud, Aruba, and ATT Flexware, with forecasted product and services revenue of \$150M.

Medtronic Remote Care Project, November 2020 - Present

Customer Problem: Medtronic is the largest global medical device manufacturer, ranking #160 on the Fortune 500 with ~\$30B in revenue. Many Medtronic products are installed and connected in hospitals, clinics, and pharmacies on networks they do not control. Maintenance on these devices and platforms was performed by sending technicians onsite with laptops and other serviceability tools they connected locally. With the onset of the pandemic, site access was restricted — leaving Medtronic to identify a new service practice methodology. They came up with Project Lighthouse as a remote maintenance system and requested Cisco to partner with them to design and build a prototype platform.

Customer Solution: Working with fellow PA Bryn Pounds, the account team, and BE resources, Brenden led the creation of a reference architecture design for Project Lighthouse. Starting with customer discovery workshops, the team gathered application and system requirements, documented use cases, and identified outstanding challenges to solve. Several designs were evaluated looking at device discovery, gateway acquisition, zero-touch provisioning, software maintenance, traffic monitoring, and system resiliency. The proposed design is combination of Meraki, Great Bear edge application platform, and MSX orchestration. Joint testing of the Lighthouse application on Cisco platform is underway.

Business Impact: The Medtronic remote care project represents an opportunity for Cisco to sign a development partnership with Medtronic and build a solution to suit healthcare, manufacturing, and financial services verticals.

Accenture Next Gen Digital Office, October 2020 - Present

Customer Problem: Accenture adopts new technologies very early in the lifecycle curve. Two examples are public cloud adoption, where 90% of their workloads are deployed, and VPN-less zero-trust application access, which they leverage extensively. The Accenture network encompasses ~800 sites globally with sizes ranging from 50 to 5,000+ users, and they use a best-of-breed approach to designing and building sites for routing, switching, and security. To simplify design, implementation, and operations as part of their Digital 2025 initiative, Accenture reached out to Cisco for assistance building their next-generation digital office aligned to cloud management, automation, and security.

Customer Solution: Leading a small contingent of account and extended team resources, Brenden designed the proposed next-generation digital office architecture concentrating on a Dev Sec Ops methodology, API-only configuration execution, and Day 0 security policy delivered as code. MSX delivers the entire site network configuration via API, building a Meraki organization with full stack SD WAN, wired, wireless, and policy-based routing. Depending on the site type, MSX pushes security setup to FirePower/FMC or manages a third-party vendor firewall for local traffic control and instantiates SASE setup to Umbrella SIG for traffic destined to the Internet or public cloud IaaS apps.

Business Impact: The Accenture next-generation digital office is an opportunity to establish a standard build practice Accenture would replicate to their customers with forecasted product and services revenue of \$60M.

Performance IT Reference Collateral, August 2020 – Present

Customer Problem: Mayo Clinic and Cisco agreed to run a Performance IT engagement with the objective to align to Mayo's Vision 2030 initiatives. Performance IT is a Cisco engagement that examines a customer's technical as-is architecture and proposes network transformation to attain a to-be design considering business metrics and financial ROI. During the as-is discovery readout, Mayo identified a gap in Cisco's engagement collateral, which did

not offer any industry benchmark information for either the healthcare sector or other vertical segments. Similarly, during the to-be architecture proposal stages, Mayo provided feedback that Cisco lacked concise product highlight documentation.

Customer Solution: Working with Performance IT team leads, Brenden directed the creation of industry benchmarks and an extensive library of 1-page product summaries across multiple platform domains. He identified six network and five security categories to be measured pre- and post-transformation, along with a capabilities summary that resulted in the improvement. Brenden also designed a scoring system and provided detailed technical notes with supporting evidence for score calculations, and he created 1-page product summaries for 15 distinct platforms and presented the findings to the customer in final to-be readouts. The industry benchmarks and 1-page summaries are now widely used in all Performance IT engagements.

Business Impact: Creating the Performance IT reference collateral eliminated two gaps in our standard customer engagement collateral and created a blueprint for generating additional collateral in large-scale opportunities.

SONiC Open-Source Development, July 2019 - Present

Customer Problem: Cisco has two primary data center platforms in Application Center Infrastructure (ACI) and Nexus Dashboard Fabric Orchestrator (NDFC), both leveraging the NX-9K switch platform. NX-9K did not qualify as a disaggregated platform as the hardware ships with pre-loaded NX-OS software. SONiC/SAI is a popular open-source operating system and development framework created by Microsoft, which Cisco had limited engineering support for on the NX-9K. Target is a customer that prefers disaggregated platforms and open-source software, and they requested that Cisco invest more development time and expanded features for SONiC/SAI on the NX-9K platform.

Customer Solution: Working in close partnership with account team and customer, Brenden guided efforts to drive the data center networking BE to further develop SONiC/SAI on NX-9K platform. The customer planned to use the NX-9K switch with SONiC/SAI in their stores, so missing campus features like PoE, MGig, and 802.1x were the priorities. Brenden generated business case justification and product requirements documents to get features added to SONiC/SAI and helped the customer perform functional testing. SONiC/SAI operating system changes and feature additions have been upstreamed into the main code repositories, which are available internally to Cisco account teams and industry wide.

Business Impact: The SONiC open-source development work has expanded the scope of use cases where the NX-9K products can be positioned and resulted in Cisco becoming relevant to specific GES and MSDC customers.

SAE as a Service Platform 1Edge, April 2019 - Present

Customer Problem: Secure Agile Exchange (SAE) is one of Cisco's carrier neutral facility (CNF) focused offers that automates provisioning of switching, routing, and VNF/PNF service chains to connect consumers to providers. The market demand and customer interest in SAE has been significant, but SAE has struggled to gain market share for several reasons. It competes with another internal product providing similar capabilities called Cloud onRamp (CoR) for CoLocation, it's been a costly DIY platform, and it has long design, planning, and installation timelines. Customer feedback on SAE has consistently been to move it to an as-a-service model to make it easier to deploy.

Customer Solution: Partnering with product management, CX services, and sales teams, Brenden led an initiative to create a Cloud Edge as a service (CEaaS) offer. The team completed a full workup of prospective customers with design requirements, use cases, and associated revenue opportunity. A business case was developed with a proposed platform architecture and financial investment view on needed commitments and timeframes to move forward with CEaaS. That initial proposal was ultimately rejected, yet internal and customer demand remained strong. A second effort in direct partnership with NSBU restarted the CEaaS offer and it's moving ahead as a renamed platform called 1Edge.

Business Impact: Creating the SAE as a Service 1Edge platform gives Cisco a competitive offer in market and furthers our Equinix partnership yielding a pipeline of ~100 GES customers with revenue potential of ~\$25M.

Humana Healthcare Branch in a Box, September 2018 – Present

Customer Problem: Humana Healthcare suffered from reliability challenges attributed to outages and associated downtime both in their DCs and remote clinic and pharmacy locations. The design they had, which was based on centralized DCs with hub and spoke MPLS to remote sites, was resulting in sub-optimal application performance and user experience. Leadership made the decision to right-size their DCs and transition to a cloud-first model for

application placement and consumption. To further address the challenges, they decided to adopt an XaaS model consuming everything as a service. Humana tasked Cisco with building a fully cloud-delivered and cloud-optimized branch-in-a-box solution.

Customer Solution: Leading an assortment of Cisco account and CX team resources, Brenden built a model for a repeatable process solution capable of being drop-shipped to a site for fully automated startup without requiring a technician to be dispatched. LANaaS was created using the Meraki platform for wired wireless, and integrated network and physical security with full zero-touch provisioning. SDWANaaS was designed for 305 sites with the ability to build a seamless cutover with no service interruptions. The result of the branch-in-a-box offer was improved network stability and uptime with cloud-optimized traffic routing. It also achieved their goal of rapid onboarding of new acquisitions.

Business Impact: The Humana Healthcare branch in a box solution resulted in Cisco successfully displacing Aruba and building a fully managed LAN and WAN as a service offer with booked product and services revenue of \$10M.

Hybrid Cloud Utility Development, August 2017 - Present

Customer Problem: Public cloud has changed how compute resources are consumed and has provided a baseline set of capabilities now considered table stakes — particularly around automation, scaling, and user experience. Cisco has provided DIY reference architecture designs for customers to build hybrid cloud platforms based on Intersight, UCS and HyperFlex, ACI and NX-9K, and third-party storage. The customer challenge has been DIY integration and the absence of pre-built offers with as-a-service consumption models. Thomson Reuters approached Cisco about developing an integrated full-stack hybrid cloud utility platform built with a pay-as-you-grow consumption model.

Customer Solution: Partnering with the account team and the customer, Brenden created a full-stack hybrid cloud design and worked with the cloud networking BE and CX Services to create an offer program. Starting with the customer requirements and use cases, he identified a reference design with network, compute, storage, tooling, and automation. He then engaged CX Services to build as-a-service models for pay-as-you-grow and pay-as-you-use consumption and brought in the SET team to create commercial rate cards for services offers, including BM, VM, Hadoop, and K8S. The prototype hybrid cloud utility platform evolved into Project Athena and became Cisco+ Hybrid Cloud — Cisco's first as-a-service offer.

Business Impact: The hybrid cloud utility platform development jumpstarted work on Project Athena resulting in the creation of Cisco+ Hybrid Cloud offer with a pipeline of ~20 GES customers with revenue potential of ~\$25M.

Project Magellan DNA Spaces Development, June 2017 - Present

Customer Problem: Segmentation is arguably the most prominent use case for intent-based networking design and deployment of campus wired + wireless infrastructure and IoT. One of the main segmentation obstacles is the ability to monitor user and device behavior and provide analytics on logical groupings and how policy gets assigned based upon typical network behavior. Most customers do not have these capabilities, nor do they understand relationships between consumers and providers. To address this challenge, Mayo Clinic requested Cisco consider developing a tool for policy discovery, visualization, automation, and assurance to decrease segmentation enablement timeframes.

Customer Solution: Working in close coordination with the customer, account team, and the Enterprise Network BE, Brenden drove development of Project Magellan, which was officially added to the DNA portfolio and named DNA Spaces. Starting from Stealthwatch-NetFlow data feeds and Excel spreadsheets, the team mocked up customer use cases and outlined minimum viable product for inclusion in the PRD. Bi-weekly cadence meetings with engineering were held, and Mayo was a beta customer. However, delivery dates slipped and the customer opted to utilize a competitive product. DNA Spaces finally shipped and is now Cisco's flagship policy discovery, automation, and validation tool.

Business Impact: The project Magellan development spearheaded by a partnership with Mayo Clinic resulted in the creation of the DNA Spaces platform which generates \$200M annually in Cisco enterprise networks revenue.

Sponsorship

Direct Leadership

Sponsorship letters from Direct Leadership listed below are located [here](#).

Name	Role	Organization
Nadine Fakhoury - Sponsor	Senior Director	GES Systems Engineering and Architectures
Eric Fryland - Sponsor	Director	Systems Engineering – GES TECH

BE Leadership

Sponsorship letters from BE Leadership listed below are located [here](#).

Name	Role	Organization
Ish Limkakeng	Senior Vice President/General Manager	Cloud Networking
Kaustubh Dah	Senior Vice President/General Manager	Engineering - CSPG
Ronak Desai	Senior Vice President	Engineering - DCN
Ravi Chandra	Senior Vice President	Engineering - EN
TK Keanini	Chief Technology Officer	Security Business Group
Thomas Scheibe	Vice President	DC Switching Marketing

Sales Leadership

Sponsorship letters from Sales Leadership listed below are located [here](#).

Name	Role	Organization
Rachel Barger	Senior Vice President	GES Sales
Eric Knipp	Vice President	Sales Systems Engineering - Americas
Gordon Thomson	Vice President	EMEAR Architectures and Sales Specialists
Shelly Blackburn	Vice President	Global Security Sales
Emily Crawford	Vice President	Area Sales – GES Central
Jeremy Foster	Vice President	Global Sales, Cloud Infrastructure and Software Group

Customer/Partner

Sponsorship letters from Customers and Partners listed below are located [here](#).

Name	Role	Organization
Steve DeMuth	Chief Technology Officer	Mayo Clinic
Jason Nollinger	Vice President, Information Technology	UnitedHealth Group
David Smith	Vice President and Manager, Core Network Engineering	US Bank
Bill Jones	Staff Vice President, Infrastructure Services	Anthem Healthcare
Frank Macioce	Chief Network Architect	Nationwide Insurance

DA/PA Community

Sponsorship letters from the DA/PA Community listed below are located [here](#).

Name	Role	Organization
Matt Gillies	Cisco Fellow, Chief Architect	WW Systems Engineering and Technology
Carlos Pereira	Cisco Fellow, Chief Architect	Emerging Technologies and Incubation, Applications

Jamey Heary	Chief Security Architect	Global Multi-Domain Security Engineering
Craig Hill	Distinguished Architect	U.S. Public Sector CTO Office
David Jansen	Distinguished Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Khalil Jabr	Distinguished Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Errol Roberts	Distinguished Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Brian Shlisky	Distinguished Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Bill DuFresne	Distinguished Architect	U.S. Commercial CTO Office
Vaughn Suazo	Distinguished Architect	Americas Service Provider
Charles Duffy	Distinguished Engineer	EN&C Strategy & Operations
Scott Van de Houten	Distinguished Architect - Retired	GES Office of the CTO
Darrin Miller	Distinguished Technical Marketing Engineer	ENB TME Platforms
Lukas Krattiger	Distinguished Technical Marketing Engineer	DC Switching Marketing
Christopher Paggen	Distinguished Engineer, Insieme Marketing	Insieme Marketing Belgium
Mike Storm	Distinguished Engineer	CSOG – SBG Competitive Special Ops
Sean McGee	Senior Director	Global Specialists, CISG Architecture Team
Prashant Tripathi	Principal Architect, Chief Architect and CTO, SD-WAN	Enterprise Networking and Software Sales
Jeff Fanelli	Principal Security Architect	Global Multi-Domain Security Engineering
Bryn Pounds	Principal Architect	Enterprise Networking and Software Sales
Cesar Obediente	Principal Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Anthony Sabella	Principal Architect	GES Office of the CTO
Keith Weaver	Principal Architect	GES South ENG
Chris Gascoigne	Principal Architect	APJ Data Centre, ANZ Arch SE
Tjerk Bijlsma	Principal Architect, CTO Cloud	EMEAR Cloud and Architecture Team Netherlands
Andy Sholomon	Senior Director, Technical Marketing	DC Switching Marketing
Jason McGee	Director, Principal Architect	DC Compute Sales
Max Ardica	Principal Engineer	Insieme Marketing France
Carlos Campos	Principal Architect	DCN Controller

Personal Development

Brenden has consistently and energetically invested in expanding his skillsets, focusing on both professional and personal development. What stands out most is his ability to adapt to the changing business climate and company priorities to ensure field alignment and drive greater business impact.

He has steadily expanded into new areas of expertise — volunteering to attend trainings, partake in bootcamps, and join planning/strategy events. Brenden leads by example being amongst the first to build specialized knowledge in areas Cisco has prioritized as strategic to the business, including network programmability, automation and orchestration, SASE and remote work, security, SD WAN and cloud edge.

He has participated exhaustively in the internal VT programs coordinating, presenting, contributing, and attending DC-SEVT, Security-SEVT, and EN-SEVT in person and virtually. His efforts have focused on driving internal initiatives like Performance IT and SASE and in many cases, he's not just receiving the training, he's also building and delivering it to broader Ops, Area, and Segment audiences.

Brenden works to develop his skills beyond acquisition of technical knowledge to include communications and soft skills focused initiatives like executive coaching, recording live training whiteboard sessions, and building a team to author his third book.

He's also been a regular contributor to customers acting as guest presenter at their sponsored onsite technology events. The results of his investment in personal development have directly affected his ability to impact business as he works on broader and more strategic sales engagements.

He's taken this knowledge and had broader global impact by driving training and sales enablement. Brenden's personal development has resulted in more sustained engagement with product development, engineering, and leadership to drive strategy, go to market plans, and technical investments.

EDUCATION and CERTIFICATIONS

- St. Olaf College, Bachelor of Arts (Economics & Math), 1984-1988
- CCIE R&S #2073 Active, 1996-2016
- CCIE R&S #2073 Lifetime Emeritus, 2016-Present

TRAINING SESSIONS and BOOTCAMPS

Security Technical Advisory Groups (TAG) – January 2020 – Present

- Cloud Native & Applications Security Monthly TAG
- CX Security/BU ISE Interlock Initiative Meeting

DC-SEVT, Security-SEVT, EN-SEVT – Multiple events, January 2018 – Present

- DC-SEVT – in-person attendance: November 2019, May 2019, November 2018, May 2018; virtual attendance: March 2022, October 2021, March 2021, January 2021, October 2020, May 2020
- Security SEVT – in-person attendance: April 2018, October 2018, April 2019, October 2019; virtual attendance: October 2021, February 2021, November 2020, May 2020
- EN-SEVT – virtual attendance: February 2022, November 2021, April 2021, October 2020, April 2020, October 2019, April 2019, October 2018, April 2018
- Field Advisor DC-SEVT - Lead FA for ACI track, team member NX-OS track, multi-session presenter, multi-session owner, partner VT: January 2018 – December 2021,

ISE Top Gun Master Series – 4 sessions, March 2022 – May 2022

- Session 1 – Engaging the Bogey
- Session 2 – Reading the Radar
- Session 3 – Engaging Autopilot
- Session 4 – Design and Scaling Best Practice

SASE Competitive Series Training – 3 sessions, February 2022 – April 2022

- Session 1 – Perimeter 81 and iBoss
- Session 2 – Zscaler and Palo Alto Networks
- Session 3 – Fortinet and VMware

Full Stack Observability (FSO) Training – 2 sessions, February 2022

- FSO Fundamentals, FSO offers
- Customer win using AWS route to market
- FSO demonstration best practices

MSX NPI Workshop Training – 4 multi-day sessions, February 2021 - February 2022

- MSX 4.2 NPI – 1 session, February 2022, What's New in MSX 4.2, Meraki Enhancements, MDO Enhancements, Automated DNA-C Onboarding, MSX-Lite
- MSX 4.1 NPI – 2 sessions, September 2021, What's New in MSX 4.1, Meraki Enhancements, Compliance Enhancements, TLS Gateway, MSX-Lite
- MSX 4.0 NPI – 2 sessions, July 2021, What's New in MSX 4.0, Tenant Centric UI, Compliance and Vulnerability, NAC with ISEaaS
- MSX 3.10 NPI – 5 sessions, February 2021, What's New in MSX 3.10, ServiceNow Integration, Managed Device, Workflow, SD WAN, Enterprise Access

Executive Coaching – 6 sessions, January 2021 – February 2022

- Nominated and selected to participate in executive coaching series with Victor McGuire from Coaching for Life <https://coachingforeveryone.org/>
- Completed in-depth StandOut assessment, which identified the focal point of Brenden's talents and skills as an Advisor and a Pioneer
- Collaborated with Victor to build a plan to step up efforts to gain DA nomination and complete the process of applying for DA designation
- Worked with Victor to identify areas where Brenden could provide more leadership and greater impact from an individual contributor role

Retail Bootcamp Training – 4 sessions, August 2021 – September 2021

- Overview of the retail industry and market trends
- Clear understanding of Cisco's retail strategy and go-to-market initiatives
- Business Architecture Roadmap (BAR) for your customer
- Line-of-business pitch for one opportunity identified through the BAR process
- Opportunity battlecard to develop that identified opportunity

Cloud & Infrastructure Automation – 4 sessions, May 2021 – June 2021

- Native Constructs 101 – Containers / Docker / Microservices / Kubernetes
- Native Constructs 201 – Public Cloud Services and Terminology
- Cloud Day 0/1 – Infrastructure as Code, Orchestration
- Cloud Day 2 Ops – Orchestration (cont'd) / Observability

MSX Hands on Lab Training – 1 session, May 2021

- Internally completed version of CiscoLive MSX hands on lab – 146-page lab guide

SASE Workshop – 2 days, November 2020 – December 2020

- Review and discuss cross-product/cross-BU SASE perspectives
- Develop and define key pillars of Cisco's SASE transition for the short, medium, and long terms
- Begin development of a targeted business strategy to drive an aligned portfolio-wide adoption plan
- Identify key program action items, who owns them, and what the expected outcomes should be

Selling in a Virtual World Training – 2 sessions, October 2020

- The Oratium model excels in the virtual environment because it inherently corrects for distraction, low customer bandwidth, and a potential lack of social cues. This 2-day course on sales message design and delivery will teach you how to employ a new sales channel not merely to survive but to significantly thrive as you "out-message" the competition.

Book Sprint Writing #3 – 2 weeks, September 2020

- Coordinated third book sprint writing project, secured sponsorship and funding, recruited book writing team, arranged schedule and logistics

- Designed the first Cisco Book Sprint project completed virtually using remote work and 2-week staggered writing/proofing schedule
- Completed 302-page book focused on building hybrid multicloud data centers, individually contributed chapters on connectivity and security
- Published “Adopting and Operating Hybrid Cloud Data Centers,” posted to SalesConnect: <https://www.cisco.com/c/dam/en/us/products/se/2020/10/Collateral/data-center-ebook.pdf>
<https://salesconnect.cloudapps.cisco.com/vid/index.html?cid=1f544f8f-5e43-4eb9-aa02-c0ff87a054c1>

vCTO Summit Training Enablement – 3 days, April 2020 – August 2020

- Annual vCTO extended team meeting focused on Cisco horizon-1 priorities and horizon-2 emerging technologies

DevNet Training Bootcamp – 11 sessions, April 2020 – June 2020

- VIRT/CML-E
- Ansible / Jina2
- Netconf/Restconf - IOSXE/NX-OS
- pyATS/Genie
- Docker
- CI/CD – GitLab
- Postman / Meraki API
- Webex API / Webex team sdk
- DNAC API
- DC Automation – ACI
- vManage API

Performance IT Training – 5 days/4 sessions, February 2018 – June 2020

- Picked as Central Area Performance IT Co-Lead to establish Performance IT practice engagement model and go to market strategy (2-day kickoff workshop)
- Worked through and created customer selection criteria for Performance IT centrally led model and Performance IT Lite model
- Developed domain level design architectures for data center, compute/storage, hybrid multicloud, campus, WAN, cloud edge, security, and automation
- Built condensed curriculum and collateral, jointly re-delivered training class 3x to Central Area audience comprised of AM/SE/TSA/PSS and Ops/Area leadership

Action Orchestrator Bootcamp – 4 days, April 2020

- Enrolled in 4-day instructor led immersive training bootcamp covering Kubernetes and Cisco Action Orchestrator (AO)
- 5 complete hands-on labs, including Kubernetes setup, AO install, Basic Workflow Authoring, Advanced Workflow Authoring, and Adapter Development
- Included a single day Hackathon where students applied all they had learned to build new automation workflows
- Training supported multidomain orchestration (MDO) SWAT Team efforts and broader initiatives around MSX and SecureX, both of which integrate AO

Cisco Workload Optimization Manager Training – 1 day, January 2020

- Introduction to CWOM
- Policies & Applications
- Planning & Administration Settings
- Analysis Settings, Dashboards & Reports

- ServiceNow Integration

Virtual Training Immersive Experience – 2 Lightboards Sessions, October 2019 – January 2020

- Designed and delivered live whiteboarding session on Cisco Hybrid Cloud vs VMware
- “Extending ACI to Multi-DC and Hybrid Cloud Environments” (10/15/19)
- Designed and delivered live whiteboarding session on Cisco Cloud Story vs Arista
- “Arista DASH Competitive Immersive Experience 3 Live!” (01/14/20)

MSX Global Enterprise Go-to-Market Planning – 4 days/2 sessions, April 2019 - August 2019

- Small group interlock meeting with PA/DA team and BE to strategize on business justification for MSX to be used in Global Enterprise for multidomain orchestration
- Captured customer use cases, identified portfolio gaps, documented financial opportunity, created enterprise-focused technical collateral, designed training enablement plan

Ansible Fest Training – 1 session, October 2018

- NetDevOps – Batteries and Pipeline Included with Cisco NSO and Ansible

Internet Technology Exchange (ITX) – 1 day, June 2018

- Hosted Thomson Reuters at David Ward’s customer event focused on emerging technologies

Viptela SD WAN Training – 4 days, March 2018

- Day 1 – SD-WAN Solution Overview, SD-WAN Licensing Model, Secure Control Plane Bring-Up, Secure Data Plane Bring-Up
- Day 2 – Overlay Management Protocol (OMP), Using Templates, Using Policies, Quality of Service (QoS)
- Day 3 – Basic Troubleshooting, Additional Topics, Cloud OnRamp, Use Cases and Designs, Multi-Tenancy
- Day 4 – vAnalytics and REST API, Labs (spread out evenly across all four days based on progress in the curriculum)

Secure Multi-Tenancy Summit – 2 days, March 2018

- Validate multi-tenancy use cases
- Review existing multi-tenancy solutions and requirements
- Map existing solutions to future use cases across all segments
- Identify new firewall insertion points and trends
- Identify feature gaps and improvement opportunities
- Agree on collateral and product deliverables

Cisco Network Assurance Engine Training – 1 day, March 2018

- Predict impact of changes
- Assure security policy compliance
- Verify networkwide behavior

Target Network Programmability Hackathon – 1/3 Proctors, 3 days January 2018

- Education – Presented DevNet network programmability and DevOps curriculum
- Discovery – Reviewed customer challenges with current network management process
- Ideation – Generated list of potential automation use cases – basic, intermediate, advanced
- Creation – Collaborated to build network programmability code to address use cases

SE Community Leadership

Brenden has been an extremely strong advocate of the broader SE community, driving initiatives, programs, mentorship, and technical enablement, and supporting strategic customer engagements. One of the most prominent aspects of this is his willingness and ability to present at customer executive briefings across a wide spectrum of technical topics. He has spoken at 47 in-person or virtual EBCs in the last 4 years and is most commonly asked to cover end-end enterprise architecture, due to his ability to bridge complex designs across data center, multicloud, campus, WAN, branch, and remote work with embedded security and automation.

Brenden is a coveted speaker given his strong communications skills and ability to connect with people at all levels, from technical architects to mid-level management and into senior leadership.

Brenden has supported the SE ranks through his leadership roles with the DC-SEVT program as the ACI track lead and CiscoLive US and EMEA as a data center track SGM. He has built program curriculum, worked with candidates to successfully achieve speaker status, and coached them to refine content and on delivery best practices. He has driven many training enablement efforts spanning multiple global geographies as a program coordinator, SME speaker, or rebroadcasting content he learned as an attendee.

Brenden is frequently asked to drive continuing education as a featured speaker at a multitude of enablement events across the segment, area, and operation levels. He has been at the forefront of new techniques to drive content to the SE community, recording Lightboard competitive videos, hosting use case workshops, and building writing teams to create books. Brenden is often the voice of the field as a regular presenter and contributor to senior leadership meetings. A list of his speaking engagements is below.

TRAINING SESSIONS

Talent Expo Leader Connects Program – Mentor/Sponsor, June 2020 – Present

- Event objective was to identify early-in-career minority candidates and match them with two internal Cisco leaders to share their work journey and discuss opportunities
- Volunteered to sponsor a candidate and was matched with Simone Richards from the Webex team, worked with her generate a 1-page work summary and prepare for interview topics with leaders
- Simone showed an interest in meeting with Liz Centoni, who leads ET&I, so Brenden coordinated a 1-hour meeting with Liz to talk about minority women in the technology field
- Beyond just a 1-time event, Simone and Brenden have remained on a monthly meeting cadence for ongoing mentoring and opportunity sponsorship

Executive Briefing Speaking Engagements – Featured Speaker, January 2018 – Present

- Global Enterprise Segment EBC presenter – data center, SAN/storage, hybrid multicloud, cloud edge, zero-trust, SASE, enterprise architecture
- 2022 (5) - Indiana University Health, Cargill, Progressive Insurance, Anthem Healthcare, Mayo Clinic
- 2021 (8) – Silicon Valley Bank, Abbott Labs, Ford Motor Company, US Bank, Fannie Mae, Eli Lilly, McDonald's, Zions Bank
- 2020 (11) – Medtronic, UnitedHealth Group, Fannie Mae, Anthem Healthcare, McDonald's, Comerica, W.R. Berkley, United Airlines, Mayo Clinic, Booz Allen, CareSource
- 2019 (13) – Best Buy, Huntington Bank, Humana Healthcare, State Farm, Abbott Labs, Thomson Reuters (2), Nationwide Insurance, Fairview Healthcare, Marriott International, Medtronic, Anthem Healthcare, UnitedHealth Group
- 2018 (10) – Thomson Reuters, State Farm (2), Ameriprise, Johnson Controls, Humana Healthcare, Baxter Healthcare, Progressive Insurance, Accenture, Cargill

CiscoLive Data Center SGM - US & EMEA, November 2017 – Present

- Part of a 4-member Session Group Manager team covering data center track, which is made up of ACI, standalone NX-OS, UCS/HX, and Nexus Dashboard

- Reviewed all Call for Submission (CFP) proposals, scored and ranked all submissions, built DC track curriculum, and approved/rejected sessions
- Worked with proposed/approved speakers on session development, abstract writing, presentation skills, collateral creation, and practice sessions
- Coordinated building week-long journey maps for customer session attendees with a focus on ACI track, NX-OS track, UCS/HX track, and Day-2 Operations track

Multidomain Orchestration Leadership Update – Featured Presenter, December 2021

- Presented customer use case examples from Mayo Clinic, Costco, State Farm, and Pfizer to senior leadership members Todd Nightingale, Kip Compton, and ~30 total attendees
- Supporting event for multidomain orchestration (MDO) business justification and strategy efforts, working to gain leadership commitment and engineering investment

Central Area Data Center SEVT Debrief – 4 sessions, June 2018 – November 2021

- Condensed multiple days of DC-SEVT content into 2 hours of material, and arranged a multi-speaker team to present it to a Central Area AM/SE/PSS/TSA audience
- Presented debrief June 2018, November 2019, July 2020, and November 2021

SE FY22 Q1 All Hands Meeting – Featured Presenter, October 2021

- Introducing Cisco MSX for Multidomain Orchestration

Great North Operation All-Hands Meeting – Featured Presenter, August 2021

- SD-WAN SDCI – Multi-Cloud Access and Middle-Mile Optimization

World Wide Technology SASE Enablement Training – Featured Presenter, July 2021

- Cisco's SASE Architecture – Secure Access Services Edge (SASE)

Data Center SEVT Lead ACI – Coordinator/Presenter, January 2018 – May 2021

- Leader of ACI and Day-2 Operations track team (BU's #1 priority topic) for DC-SEVT event planning, logistics, and scheduling
- Collaborated with BE to identify 12-month priorities, worked with the team to capture session proposals, and priority ranked and presented session recommendations
- Partnered with session owners to identify speakers, build session abstracts, develop session collateral, identify Q&A managers and polling plans, and schedule dry-run sessions
- Multi-session owner, multi-session speaker, lead Q&A manager for BU sessions, and led planning for supporting VT mini-series and Partner VT event

Heartland Operation All-Hands Meeting – Featured Speaker, April 2021

- Cisco SASE Architecture – Secure Access Services Edge

SASE Webinar Series – Plan, Build, Delivery, March 2021 – April 2021

- Cisco Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) Explained – 51 attendees, score 4.38
- From SD-WAN to Secure Branch – 54 attendees, score 4.75
- Securing the Remote Worker Through SASE – 49 attendees, score 4.52
- The Future of SASE and IT Networks – 42 attendees, score 4.29

Q2 Central Area Pursuit Team Sound Byte – Featured Presenter, March 2021

- Cisco Integrated Observability Solutions – Full Stack Observability

Big Rivers Operation All-Hands Meeting – Featured Speaker, March 2021

- Cisco SASE Architecture – Secure Access Services Edge

FY21 Central Area Weekly Enablement Series – Featured Presenter, October 2020 – February 2021

- February 2021 – MSX/MDO for Multidomain Orchestration
- January 2021 – Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) Part 2
- November 2020 – SecureX, Experience Simplified
- October 2020 – Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) Part 1

Worldwide SASE Training Enablement – Plan, Build, Delivery, June 2020 – February 2021

- Designed and created SASE SE training outline, and worked with SASE SWAT team coordinator Iftach Socher to coordinate and schedule five 90-minute sessions
- Identified speakers and Q&A panelists, planned training curriculum, created training collateral, and worked with team to build supporting demos (live and pre-recorded)
- Arranged dry-run training sessions presented to senior sales and sales engineering leadership audiences for GES East, GES West, GES Central, GES South and USPS
- Worked with senior geo-leaders for session sponsorship; Eric Knipp – Americas, Koen Jacobs – EMEAR, Raymond Janse van Rensburg – APJC, and Shelly Blackburn – GSSO
 - Americas Partner Community – 02/02/21, 500 attendees
 - EMEAR #2 – 11/17/20, 436 attendees, session score 4.75
 - APJC – 10/29/20, 280 attendees, session score 4.84
 - EMEAR #1 – 10/28/20, 679 attendees, session score 4.58
 - Americas – 10/27/20, 1,786 attendees, session score 4.86

CX Services SIA Team Training – Featured Speaker, January 2021

- Requested to speak at annual CX Services SIA technical summit focused on Next Generation Data Center – 4 sessions delivered across 3 days of presentations
- ACI Anywhere – Extending Policy to Public Cloud
- Cisco's Multidomain Architecture for Intent-Based Networking
- SASE - Secure Access Services Edge Americas Training
- Cisco Nexus Dashboard – Comprehensive NetOps and Visibility

Canada Team Cloud Strategy Training – Featured Speaker, October 2020

- Systems Engineering Director for Canada Rupinder Singh reached out with a request to train their entire SE team on Cisco's cloud strategy and plans
- Partnered with DSA Rob Barton, DSA David Jansen, and PSA Cesar Obediente to draft the agenda and build the curriculum outline for the session
- Jointly delivered w/PSA Cesar Obediente cloud strategy session to ~80 field technical resources covering cloud connectivity, cloud automation, cloud security, and cloud visibility
- Distributed session recording and presentation collateral to US-based counterparts across 5 main geographies – East, Central, South, West, and Premier

SASE SWAT Team Leadership Readout – Featured Presenter, September 2020

- SASE SWAT team initial readout on SASE market, GTM plans, use cases and roadmap, solution gaps, field enablement, and action item asks to senior leadership
- SASE SWAT Team Readout

MDO SWAT Team Leadership Readout – Featured Presenter, September 2020

- MDO SWAT team initial readout, MDO current status, customer use cases, and action item asks to senior leadership
- MDO SWAT Team Readout

One Network Customer Use Case Workshops – Plan, Build, Delivery, July 2020

- As part of the DC-SEVT program, Brenden designed a new workshop event where teams received background information and resources and had to build and deliver a customer pitch in 1 hour

- Conducted both seminar topics 2x to 5 SE groups per session, roleplayed customer, and provided interactive feedback, scored, ranked, and awarded winning teams
- One Network “Deploy Faster” – 1. Response to a Customer’s Need, 2. Competitive and/or Harsh Situation, 3. The “Quota-Maker”
- Simplify Operations “Minimize Downtime” - 1. Response to a Customer’s Need, 2. Competitive and/or Harsh Situation, 3. The “Quota-Maker”

Security Technical Advisory Group Training – Featured Speaker, April 2020

- Building a Zero Trust Secure Data Center Environment – ACI Fabric Security Update

VTIE Competitive Video Training – Plan, Build, Delivery, September 2019 – January 2020

- Designed and delivered live whiteboarding session on Cisco Hybrid Cloud vs VMware
- “Extending ACI to Multi-DC and Hybrid Cloud Environments” – 10/15/19
- Designed and delivered live whiteboarding session on Cisco Cloud Story vs Arista
- “Arista DASH Competitive Immersive Experience 3 Live!” (01/14/20)

Cloud Edge Customer/Partner Workshops – Plan, Build, Delivery November 2019 – December 2019

- December 2019, Pittsburgh, PA, 2-day event, 30 registered attendees
- December 2019, Minneapolis, MN, 2-day event, 35 registered attendees
- December 2019, Cincinnati, OH, 2-day event, 25 registered attendees
- November 2019, Chicago, IL, 2-day event, 40 registered attendees
- November 2019, Herndon, VA, 2-day event, 40 registered attendees
- November 2019, Southfield, MI, 2-day event, 50 registered attendees

Cisco Connect Events – Presenter, October 2018 – November 2019

- November 2019, Minneapolis, MN – Intent-Based Networking & Multidomain Integration
- November 2019, Boston, MA – Multidomain Service Delivery
- December 2018, Minneapolis, MN – Cisco DC-Cloud Strategy, Building Strategic Hybrid Multicloud Designs
- October 2018, Washington D.C. – Building a Self-Describing, Self-Healing, Self-Securing Network Architecture

VMware Blackbelt Training – Plan, Build, Delivery, May 2019 – September 2019

- As part of Project Voltron, Brendon was part of the team that designed and built a VMware competitive training outline and course curriculum for field consumption
- May 2019 - VMware advisory team met for content reviews, performed dry run of course material, and presented “How to Position ACI Anywhere Against VMware’s NSX Virtual Cloud Network”
- June 2019 – Condensed the 3-day VMware competitive course into ~2 hours of content and re-delivered the truncated curriculum to an Area AM/SE audience of ~100 sellers
- September 2019 – The VMware advisory team delivered a full 3-day VMware competitive course to a group of 200 technical sellers, all sessions were recorded and posted to SalesConnect
- Session content was reduced to 1 day and combined with Arista Blackbelt, which was also reduced to 1 day, creating a 2-day event delivered in NYC, Chicago, and Richardson

GSX/Impact Presentations – Featured Speaker, August 2018 – August 2019

- Impact 2019 – Multidomain Policy Management – Enterprise Orchestration
- GSX 2018 – Intent-Based Networking – Cloud Edge, Secure Agile Exchange

INSBU Customer Advisory Board – Customer Host – March 2017 – May 2019

- March 2019 – hosted Progressive Insurance and US Bank
- May 2018 – hosted Huntington Bank and Thomson Reuters

- December 2017 – hosted UnitedHealth Group and Progressive Insurance
- March 2017 – hosted UnitedHealth Group and Cerner

Arista Blackbelt Training – Plan, Build, Delivery, January 2019 – April 2019

- As part of Arista DASH, Brenden was part of the team that designed and built the Arista competitive training outline and course curriculum for field consumption
- January 2019 – Arista advisory team met for content reviews, performed a dry run of course material, and presented “Arista Security Segmentation Strategy”
- March 2019 – Condensed the 3-day Arista competitive course into ~2 hours of content and re-delivered the truncated curriculum to an Area AM/SE audience of ~100 sellers
- April 2019 – The Arista advisory team delivered a full 3-day Arista competitive course to a group of 300 technical sellers, all sessions recorded and posted to SalesConnect
- Session content was reduced to 1 day and combined with VMware Blackbelt, which was also reduced to 1 day, creating a 2-day event delivered in NYC, Chicago, and Richardson

Midwest Atlantic Area Competitive Update – Featured Speaker, December 2018

- VMware + Arista + Zscaler – Competitive Update for MWA

Midwest Atlantic Leadership Offsite – Featured Speaker, April 2018

- AVP Mark Houska and SED Eric Knipp held leadership offsite in Miami, FL and requested that Brenden present to the entire area team AM/SE/PSS/TSA and leadership
- Delivered “Cisco MultiCloud Strategy” and hosted a 60-minute live Q&A session

MENTORING

Brenden is currently mentoring the following PA, TSA, and leadership candidates:

- Keith Baldwin, Senior Technical Solutions Architect - mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Rick Bauer, Technical Solutions Architect – mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Bryan Byrne, Enterprise Architect - mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Ovidiu Constantin, Technical Solutions Architect - mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Mike McCullough, Business Solutions Architect - mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Sandon Molen, Systems Architect – mentoring towards Technical Solutions Architect
- Bryn Pounds, Principal Architect – mentored to Principal Architect
- Simone Richards, Project Manager – mentoring as minority leadership candidate
- Ryan Shoemaker, Technical Solutions Architect - mentoring towards Principal Architect
- Tia Stackle, Systems Architect – mentoring towards Technical Solutions Architect

PUBLICATIONS

Book Sprint Published Content

Data Center Book Sprint #3

- October 2020 - “Adopting and Operating Hybrid Cloud Data Centers”
- <https://www.cisco.com/c/dam/en/us/products/se/2020/10/Collateral/data-center-ebook.pdf>
- <https://salesconnect.cloudapps.cisco.com/vid/index.html?cid=1f544f8f-5e43-4eb9-aa02-c0ff87a054c1>

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

CiscoLive Published Content

[Details](#) are located in the External & Internal Speaking Engagements section of this document

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Competitive Published Content

Arista Blackbelt Training

- January 2019 - "Arista Security Segmentation Strategy"

Data Center SEVT Events

- May 2019 - "X-Domain Integrations – DCN Update SEVT May 2019"
- May 2019 - "Behind the Scenes: VMWare SDDC vs Cisco DC Architecture"
- November 2018 – "Network Trends, Vision & Strategy"
- May 2018 - "Birds of a Feather: ACI & SDA Integration"
- May 2018 – "VMware NSX Competitive Update"

Midwest Atlantic Area Competitive Update

- December 2018 - "VMware + Arista + Zscaler – Competitive Update for MWA"

Security SEVT Events

- April 2018 – "Cisco Tetration Platform Security SEVT May 2019"

Virtual Training Immersive Experience

- January 2020 - "Arista DASH Competitive Immersive Experience 3 Live!"
- October 2019 - "Extending ACI to Multi-DC and Hybrid Cloud Environments"

VMware Blackbelt Training

- May 2019 – "How to Position ACI Anywhere Against VMware's NSX Virtual Cloud Network"

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Leadership Readout Published Content

MDO SWAT Team Leadership Readout

- September 2020 – "MDO SWAT Team Readout"

Multidomain Orchestration Leadership Update

- December 2021 – "Competitive Intel Customer Examples"

SASE SWAT Team Leadership Readout

- September 2020 – "SASE SWAT Team Readout"

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Performance IT Published Content

Performance IT Central Area Training

- June 2018 – "ITaaB Architecture Training"
- October 2019 – "ITaaB Architecture Training"
- June 2020 – "PerfIT Architecture Training"

Performance IT Central Area Engagements

- March 2018 – "Medtronic IT as a Business As Is Summary"
- June 2018 – "Medtronic IT as a Business To Be Architecture"
- January 2020 – "T. Rowe Price IT as a Business As Is Summary"
- March 2020 – "T. Rowe Price IT as a Business To Be Architecture"
- Dec 2020 – "Mayo Clinic Performance IT As Is Summary"
- May 2021 – "Mayo Clinic Performance IT To Be Architecture"

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

Training Enablement Published Content

Canada Team Cloud Strategy Training

- October 2020 – “Canada Cloud Strategy”

Cloud Edge Customer/Partner Workshops

- December 2019 - Pittsburgh, PA, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”
- December 2019 - Minneapolis, MN, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”
- December 2019 - Cincinnati, OH, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”
- November 2019 - Chicago, IL, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”
- November 2019 - Herndon, VA, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”
- November 2019 - Southfield, MI, 2-day event, “Cloud Edge Workshop”

GSX/Impact Presentations

- Impact 2020 – Multi Domain Policy Management – Enterprise Orchestration
- GSX 2019 – Intent Based Networking – Building the End-to-End Platform for Digitization

One Network Customer Use Case Workshops

- July 2020 – “One Network - Deploy Faster”
- July 2020 – “Simplify Operations - Minimize Downtime”

SASE BDM/TDM Decks

- March 2022 - “SASE BDM Deck” (multiple revisions)
- March 2022 – “SASE TDM Deck” (multiple revisions)

SASE Webinar Series

- March 2021 - Cisco Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) Explained
- March 2021 - From SD-WAN to Secure Branch
- April 2021 - Securing the Remote Worker Through SASE
- April 2021 - The Future of SASE and IT Networks

Worldwide SASE Training Enablement

- February 2021 - Americas Partner Community, “SASE GEO Training PARTNER”
- November 2020 - EMEAR #2, “SASE GEO Training EMEAR#2”
- October 2020 – APJC, “SASE GEO Training APJC”
- October 2020 - EMEAR #1, “SASE GEO Training EMEAR#1”
- October 2020 – Americas, “SASE GEO Training AMERS”

[Documents](#) are accessible in the external Sharepoint repository

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Organization	Participation Dates	Role
Amazon Web Services Meetup	2017 - Present	Attendee
Cisco Data Center Meetup	2014 - 2020	Coordinator, Presenter, Attendee
Cisco UCS Users Group	2011 - 2020	Presenter, Attendee
DevOps Meetup	2017 - Present	Attendee
EMC Users Group	2005 - 2016	Presenter, Attendee
Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF)	2012 - Present	Monitoring – VXLAN, BGP-EVPN, TRM
Microsoft Azure Meetup	2018 - Present	Attendee
NetApp Users Group	2006 - Present	Presenter, Attendee
OpenStack Meetup	2016 - 2020	Attendee
IBM RedHat Users Group	2016 - Present	Presenter, Attendee
Storage Networking Industry Association (SNIA)	2008 - Present	Monitoring – NVMe, NVMe-oF, RoCE

Uptime Institute	2006 - 2018	Presenter, Attendee
VMware Users Group	2010 - 2016	Presenter, Attendee

EXTERNAL & INTERNAL SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

CiscoLive Events

Session ID	Session Title	Events Presented
BRKDCN-3001 2-hour breakout Attendance - ~100	Leveraging Microsegmentation to Build Comprehensive Data Center Security Architecture	CiscoLive Global 2021 (Hybrid), CiscoLive US 2020 (Virtual), CiscoLive EMEA 2020, CiscoLive US 2019, CiscoLive EMEA 2019, CiscoLive US 2018, CiscoLive EMEA 2018, CiscoLive US 2016-2017, CiscoLive EMEA 2016-2017, CiscoLive Cancun 2016 – 12 events total
BRKDCN-2939 2-hour breakout Attendance - ~80	Easy Deployment and Management of NXOS Fabrics (VXLAN) with DCNM	CiscoLive Global 2021 (Hybrid), CiscoLive US 2020 (Virtual), CiscoLive EMEA 2020 – 3 events total
TECDCN-2002 8-hour tectorial Attendance - ~75	Next Generation Data Center Infrastructure	CiscoLive EMEA 2020, CiscoLive US 2019, CiscoLive EMEA 2019, CiscoLive US 2018, CiscoLive EMEA 2018, CiscoLive US 2014-2017, CiscoLive EMEA 2015-2017 – 12 events total
BRKSEC-2719 2-hour breakout Attendance - ~40	Hybrid Cloud Security - Cisco CloudCentre, StealthWatch Cloud, AMP for Endpoints, ACI+ISE w/TrustSec, ASA/Firepower NGFW, Tetration Analytics, Cisco Threat Response, OpenDNS Umbrella	CiscoLive AUS 2019 – 1 event total
TECSEC-2723 8-hour tectorial Attendance - ~40	Architectural Approach to Security in the Enterprise Network, Data Centre and Cloud	CiscoLive AUS 2019 – 1 event total
BRKACI-2504 2-hour breakout Attendance - ~40	Cisco Security on ACI – Microsegmentation, ASA, FirePower, Tetration	CiscoLive AUS 2018 – 1 event total
TECDCN-2609 8-hour tectorial Attendance - ~20	Cisco Cloud Security	CiscoLive AUS 2018 – 1 event total

EBC Speaking Engagements

Brenden has spoken at 47 in-person or virtual EBCs spanning the last 4 years, averaging ~1 per month over that time. EBC speaking topics have been diverse, but generally the common theme is enterprise architecture and cross domain which is not a topic Cisco has many corporate resources to cover as they are devoted to single products.

Customer Name	EBC Dates	EBC Topics
Mayo Clinic	March 2022, August 2020	Enterprise Architecture, Multi Domain, Network Security
Anthem Healthcare	March 2022, February 2020, November 2019	Enterprise Architecture, Multi Domain, Multicloud, Data Center

Progressive Insurance	February 2022, July 2018	Enterprise Architecture, Data Center, Multicloud
Cargill	February 2022, November 2018	Data Center, Full Stack Observability, Cloud Edge
Indiana University Health	February 2022	Data Center, Multicloud, Multi Domain
McDonald's	December 2021, March 2020	Multi Domain, SD WAN, Cloud Edge, Zero Trust Networking
Fannie Mae	September 2021, February 2020	SASE, Orchestration, Full Stack Observability, Cloud Edge
Zions Bank	August 2021	Data Center, Core WAN
US Bank	July 2021	Enterprise Architecture, Data Center High Availability
Silicon Valley Bank	July 2021	Data Center, Multicloud, Multi Domain
Eli Lilly	June 2021	SASE, SD WAN, Network Security, Remote Work
Abbott Labs	June 2021, May 2019	Zero Trust Networking, SASE, Cloud Edge, SD WAN
Ford Motor Company	May 2021	Network Security
CareSource	December 2020	Zero Trust Networking
Booz Allen	November 2020	Data Center, Multicloud, Cloud Edge
United Airlines	October 2020	Cloud Edge, SD WAN
W.R. Berkley	September 2020	SASE, Network Security
Comerica	June 2020	Data Center, Multicloud
Medtronic	January 2020, October 2019	Enterprise Architecture, SD WAN, Cloud Edge, Zero Trust Networking
UnitedHealth Group	January 2020, December 2019	Enterprise Architecture, Data Center, Cloud Edge,
Marriott International	August 2019	SASE, Cloud Edge, SD WAN
Thomson Reuters	July 2019, June 2019, January 2018	Hybrid Cloud Utility, SD WAN, Core WAN, Secure Workload
Fairview Health	June 2019	Data Center, Multicloud
Nationwide Insurance	May 2019	SASE, SD WAN, Cloud Edge, Zero Trust Networking
State Farm Insurance	March 2019, September 2018, February 2018	Network Security, Data Center, Multicloud, Core WAN
Humana Healthcare	February 2019, June 2018	Enterprise Architecture, Data Center, Network Security, SD WAN
Huntington Bank	February 2019	Enterprise Architecture, SASE, SD WAN, Cloud Edge
Best Buy	January 2019	Data Center, Multicloud
Accenture	August 2018	Zero Trust Networking
Baxter Healthcare	June 2018	Cloud Edge, SD WAN
Johnson Controls	May 2018	Enterprise Architecture, Multi Domain, Network Security
Ameriprise Financial	April 2018	Data Center, Multicloud, Cloud Edge

INDUSTRY EVENTS

Cisco Connect 2019

- November 2019, Minneapolis, MN – Intent Based Networking & Multidomain Integration
- November 2019, Boston, MA – Multidomain Service Delivery

Cisco Impact 2019

- August 2019– Multi Domain Policy Management – Enterprise Orchestration

Cisco Connect 2018

- December 2018, Minneapolis, MN – Cisco DC-Cloud Strategy, Building Strategic Hybrid Multicloud Designs
- October 2018, Washington D.C. – Building a Self-Describing, Self-Healing, Self-Securing Network Architecture

Cisco Global Sales Experience 2018

- August 2018 – Intent-Based Networking – Cloud Edge, Secure Agile Exchange

Minnesota Partner Solutions Forum 2018

- May 2018 – Intent-Based Networking, Secured Cloud Edge Connectivity

CUSTOMER FORUMS

Caterpillar Technical Summit 2021

- January 2021, Peoria, IL - Intent Based Networking

Mayo Clinic Microsegmentation Retreat 2020

- February 2020, Rochester, MN - Microsegmentation Retreat I

Caterpillar Technical Summit 2020

- January 2020, Peoria, IL - Designing the Cloud Edge
- January 2020, Peoria, IL - Cisco DC MultiCloud Strategy

Humana Enterprise Architecture Summit 2019

- November 2019, Louisville, KY - Intent Based Networking & Multi Domain Integration

State Farm IT Symposium 2019

- October 2019, Bloomington, IL - Data Center Anywhere – Nothing “Centered” About Data Anymore, Multicloud to Multi Domain

Caterpillar Technical Summit 2019

- January 2019, Peoria IL - MultiCloud Analytics & Telemetry – ADM, Security & Workload Protection
- January 2019, Peoria, IL - Cisco Hybrid MultiCloud Strategy – Building Strategic MultiCloud Designs

Johns Hopkins Tech Day 2018

- November 2018, Baltimore, MD - Cisco Trusted Access – A Phased Trust-Centric Approach to Security

Caterpillar Technical Summit 2018

- January 2018, Peoria, IL - Cisco DC MultiCloud Strategy

Mayo Clinic AI/ML Retreat 2018

- September 2018, Rochester, MN - Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Retreat II

Mayo Clinic Segmentation Summit 2018

- September 2018, Rochester, MN - Segmentation Summit II

Mayo Clinic AI/ML Retreat 2018

- February 2018, Rochester, MN - Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Retreat I

Mayo Clinic Segmentation Summit 2018

- February 2018, Rochester, MN – Segmentation Summit I

BOOTCAMPS

SASE Webinar Series 2021

- April 2021 - Securing the Remote Worker Through SASE, 49 attendees
- April 2021 - The Future of SASE and IT Networks, 42 attendees
- March 2021 - Cisco Secure Access Services Edge (SASE) Explained, 51 attendees
- March 2021 - From SD-WAN to Secure Branch, 54 attendees

CX Services SIA Team Training 2021

- January 2021 - ACI Anywhere – Extending Policy to Public Cloud
- January 2021 - Cisco's Multidomain Architecture for Intent Based Networking
- January 2021 – SASE – Secure Access Services Edge Americas Training
- January 2021 - Cisco Nexus Dashboard – Comprehensive NetOps and Visibility

Worldwide SASE Training Enablement 2020 - 2021

- February 2021 - Americas Partner Community, 500 attendees
- November 2020 - EMEAR #2, 436 attendees
- October 2020 – APJC, 280 attendees
- October 2020 - EMEAR #1, 679 attendees
- October 2020 - Americas, 1,786 attendees

Canada Team Cloud Strategy Training 2020

- October 2020 - Cloud strategy session covering cloud connectivity, cloud automation, cloud security, and cloud visibility, 80 attendees

Virtual Training Immersive Experience Lightboard Video Training 2019 - 2020

- January 2020 - "Arista DASH Competitive Immersive Experience 3 Live!"
- October 2019 – "Extending ACI to Multi-DC and Hybrid Cloud Environments"

Performance IT Training Workshop 2018 - 2020

- June 2020 – 1 day Performance IT Workshop Training
- October 2019 – 1 day Performance IT Workshop Training
- July 2018 - 1 day Performance IT Workshop Training

Cloud Edge Customer/Partner Workshops 2019

- December 2019 - Pittsburgh, PA, 2-day event, 30 registered attendees
- December 2019 - Minneapolis, MN, 2-day event, 35 registered attendees
- December 2019 - Cincinnati, OH, 2-day event, 25 registered attendees
- November 2019 - Chicago, IL, 2-day event, 40 registered attendees
- November 2019 - Herndon, VA, 2-day event, 40 registered attendees
- November 2019 - Southfield, MI, 2-day event, 50 registered attendees

Arista Blackbelt Training 2019

- September 2019 - Session content was reduced to 1 day and combined with VMware Blackbelt, which was also reduced to 1 day, creating a 2-day event delivered in NYC, Chicago, and Richardson
- April 2019 – Arista advisory team delivered full 3-day course on Arista competitive to group of 300 technical sellers, all sessions recorded and posted to SalesConnect
- March 2019 – condensed 3-day Arista competitive course into ~2 hours of content, re-delivered truncated curriculum to Area AM/SE audience of ~100 sellers
- Jan 2019 – Arista advisory team met for content reviews, performed dry run of course material, presented “Arista Security Segmentation Strategy”

VMware Blackbelt Training 2019

- September 2019 - Session content was reduced to 1 day and combined with Arista Blackbelt, which was also reduced to 1 day, creating a 2-day event delivered in NYC, Chicago, and Richardson
- September 2019 – VMware advisory team delivered full 3-day course on VMware competitive to group of 200 technical sellers, all sessions recorded and posted to SalesConnect
- June 2019 – condensed 3-day VMware competitive course into ~2 hours of content, re-delivered truncated curriculum to Area AM/SE audience of ~100 sellers
- May 2019 - VMware advisory team met for content reviews, performed dry run of course material, presented “How to Position ACI Anywhere Against VMware’s NSX Virtual Cloud Network”

VIRTUAL TEAMS

Data Center SEVT October 2021

- Nexus Dashboard Part 1 & Part 2 – Session Owner, Session Panelist
- RoCEv2 for the Network Engineer – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT March 2021

- Nexus Dashboard and Day2 Ops Positioning, Demo Best Practices, and What’s Next – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT January 2021

- ET&I Update – Session Owner, Session Panelist
- Multicloud Networking and Cisco’s Relevance – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT October 2020

- Cloud & Compute: Vision, Strategy & Execution, Session Owner, Session Panelist
- Intersight TME Storyline: Use Cases/Best Practices – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT May 2020

- Multi Domain Policy (MDP) – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT November 2019

- Journey to ACI Anywhere, Review and Roadmap – Session Owner, Session Panelist
- ACI Fabric – The Perfect Choice for NVMe over Fabric – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT May 2019

- Multi Domain Policy – Session Owner, Session Presenter
- Behind the Scenes: VMware SDDC vs Cisco DC Architectures – Session Owner, Session Presenter
- ACI, NAE & Tetration – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Data Center SEVT November 2018

- ACI Designs and Operations Best Practices from the Front Lines – Session Owner, Session Panelist
- ACI 4.0 Update – Session Owner, Session Panelist
- Network Trends, Vision & Strategy – Session Owner, Session Presenter

Data Center SEVT May 2018

- Birds of a Feather: ACI & SDA Integration – Session Owner, Session Presenter
- VMware NSX Competitive Update – Session Owner, Session Panelist

Security SEVT April 2018

- Tetration – Session Presenter

SWAT TEAMS

MDO SWAT Team 2020-2022

- **MDO Leadership Update December 2021** - Presented customer use case examples from Mayo Clinic, Costco, State Farm, and Pfizer to Senior Leadership members Todd Nightingale, Kip Compton, and ~30 total attendees. Event was to support multidomain orchestration business justification and strategy efforts, working to gain leadership commitment and engineering investment.
- **MDO SWAT Team Readout September 2020** – Presented MDO status, customer use cases, GES plans for GTM, field enablement, and action item asks to senior leadership.

SASE SWAT Team 2020-2022

- **SASE SWAT Team Readout September 2020** – Presented on SASE market, GTM plans, use cases and roadmap, solution gaps, field enablement, and action item asks to senior leadership.

Awards & Recognition

CONNECTED RECOGNITIONS

Connected Recognition 2021

12/15/21 - You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Eric Knipp, Innovate Everywhere

Multi-Domain Solutions Work - Thank you for the creation of the customer specific multi-domain orchestration use cases. The specific details of what our customers are working to accomplish from a multi-domain perspective is very useful in our SLT BE interlock efforts with Todd Nightingale and his team.

07/26/21 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Rob Casselman, Connect Everything

Thank you for being a part of our SASE program - Brenden, I want to personally extend my gratitude and thank you for being a key contributor to our SASE program. An effort as complex and cross-architectural as SASE is no small feat. You have been instrumental in arming our sellers with cohesive, compelling resources and have set the stage for more closed SASE deals in both Q4 and beyond. As the GTM side for SASE continues to develop, so does the need for content and strategy to enable our technical sellers. From pulling together collateral to driving strategy discussions on the programmatic side, we couldn't be do this without you. Thanks for stepping up where needed and continuing to be an essential part of our SASE team! Gratefully, Rob

06/21/21 – You Accelerate 2, \$2,000, Recognized by Matt Gillies, Innovate Everywhere

MDO and SASE SWAT Team contributions - Brenden, your contributions to both the MDO and SASE swat teams, as well as your collaboration across the SE team have contributed significantly to shaping Cisco's strategy. Thanks for everything you're doing.

04/23/21 – You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Derek Bailey, Innovate Everywhere

Managed Services Accelerator go-to-market - Brenden, along with Bryn Pounds, David Jansen. Just to recognize the work you've all done to bring MSX to the forefront of Cisco's Cross-Domain architecture and vision. Often rolling a heavy ball uphill you've continued to be leaders providing your expertise, vision and guidance to others. Here's to success and customer adoption.

04/05/21 – You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Laura Simmons, Innovate Everywhere

Cisco Live Global 2021 - Thank you for your support and hard work to make our first global Cisco Live 2021 one of our most successful events for Cisco and our entire global community. We never know what to expect in a digital event, but thanks to your content, we delivered a technical program that was highly valued by customers and partners. Thank you for the commitment and passion that allowed us to pivot and deliver a digital event in such a short amount of time. Cheers to you and all that you have accomplished!

01/27/21 – You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Nitin Keskar, Connect Everything

Delivering excellent DC training content to us - Brenden, thank you so much for helping us deliver solid DC training content across multiple topics to our team: ACI Anywhere, MSX, DC/Cloud Security. Great content, excellent presentation, and the team benefited immensely from your sessions. Well done! It's been great working with you and looking forward to more to come! Thanks & regards – Nitin

01/19/21 – You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Greg Johnson, Connect Everything

Caterpillar Cloud Day - Brenden, great work on the Caterpillar Cloud Day discussions! Once again, you knocked it out of the park for us! I look forward to working with you this year on follow up opportunities from your strong presentation and discussion time. Cheers!

Connected Recognition 2020

12/02/20 – You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Eric Knipp, Connect Everything

Cloud and SASE Messaging - Guys, I cannot thank you enough for your help in creating the SASE and Cloud messaging for the Loan Depot briefing. Your thought leadership and work ethics are outstanding. Thank you!

11/02/20 – You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Brad Holst, Connect Everything

Q1 MWER Impact Award - The MWER team appreciates your leadership and support in driving opportunities across numerous accounts. A special callout has been your ongoing support of Mayo Hospital over the last 2-3 years and last week leading the Performance IT As-Is workshops. Thanks Brenden!

10/30/20 – You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Eric Knipp, Connect Everything

SASE Training - Thank you for your support in delivering an exceptional SASE training to the Americas SE organization! The phenomenal response from our team highlights how timely and relevant this material was for our SE team.

10/14/20 – You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Jeremy Foster, Benefit Everyone

Book Sprint!!! - All, thank you for the amazing amount of work that went into the book sprint! It was way above and beyond and your day jobs didn't go away despite many long days and nights pulling together an amazing product to share with our customers and field. Thank you!

09/11/20 – You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by William O'Neill, Benefit Everyone

WRB Briefing - Thank you for your participation with the Next Generation DC Briefing for W. R. Berkley.

08/01/20 – You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Matthew Smorto, Innovate Everywhere

DC VT Use Case Pitch Workshops - This team went above and beyond in the work they did on the innovative, groundbreaking and strategic DC VT Use Case Pitch Workshops in Q4. Carlos provided technical and thought leadership, and a willingness to change the face of how we enable our DC technical sellers to this endeavor, that introduce applied learning into the VT learning model. These workshops were designed not only to provide knowledge and awareness around the DC Use Cases, which underpin the highly strategic Sales Plays, but to harness the collective experience and expertise of the attendees, to develop and refine ways in which SEs pitch and demonstrate to customers. While Carlos developed the original template for the Use Cases, he helped lead a small team of SMEs to expand that to three DC Use Cases, including Simplify Operation and One Network. They helped develop a framework for the workshop itself, build 6 unique customer scenarios, and lead delivery of over 12 hours of workshops in the first week of FY21. This innovative new delivery methodology should prove to be a transformational model to help us enable our sellers to execute on our most critical strategies in FY21.

06/22/20 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Laura Simmons, Benefit Everyone

Thank you for contributing to Cisco Live! - Brenden, thank you for being an SGM for Cisco Live 2020. Little did we know that we would not only create a new virtual event in 2020 but also deliver our existing content in new and exciting ways. I appreciate your technical expertise and focus on the customers as we navigated this new world. Thank you for being patient with us as we tried out new ideas and created new processes to handle all the change. Cisco Live wouldn't exist without SGMs! Again, thank you from all of us at Cisco Live.

03/13/20 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Rob Boyts, Benefit Everyone

Saved the Day! - Brenden stepped in with very short notice to cover a 1/2 international technology briefing for CWT. Brenden covers enterprise accounts but was willing to adjust his schedule to accommodate the discussion with CWT. He took time to prep for the presentation so that the information shared would be most relevant to our customer. He didn't just "cover" the meeting, he drove a compelling, customer relevant discussion. Thanks for the teamwork!

03/12/20 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Tony Peters, Benefit Everyone

Stepping in at CWT - Thanks for stepping in on one day's notice when I contracted the flu and delivering a 3hr workshop on Cisco overall SDN strategy for Carlson Wagon Travel. It was a long planned for event and the customer had many people in from different parts of the world.

01/14/20 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Scott Jost, Innovate Everywhere

Caterpillar Tech Summit – Great Job! - Scott, Brenden and Bill: Great job with your support at the Caterpillar Tech Summit. Your dedication and technical capabilities to present the Cisco roadmaps and value proposition for our DC business was fantastic at this event. CAT is one of our most strategic customers and this event helped to solidify our position with them. Thanks!!

Connected Recognition 2019

12/10/19 - You Amaze 1, \$250 Recognized by Mirek Karczmarz, Benefit Everyone

Outstanding Customer Help - Brenden. Thank you for all your help during our United Airlines SAE workshop. Your involvement was key to our success in the distributed network architecture showcase for United. Again, we appreciate you coming down to Chicago on such a short notice to lead us. You are a great leader and an impressive individual to work together.

11/23/19 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Tammy Kufahl, Benefit Everyone

SAE Support – Traveling Knows No Rest - Brenden is amazing!!! Braden traveled all week and Friday was the only day he would be home. Our team had planned an SAE planning session on Friday. We had several key people who we were trying to impress and were not necessarily Cisco

fans in the meeting. Brenden understood our need and made plans to be there in person. That is true dedication to customer success. This represents a \$4M opportunity for the United team. Because of Brenden's leadership, we also were able to secure a Data Center briefing. One we have not been able to secure in 3 years. Brenden is truly an asset to Cisco and the United team. He came through in a pinch and gave up some family time to help us out!! It is truly appreciated!!

09/09/19 - You Inspire 2, \$50, Recognized by Nikki Moberly, Benefit Everyone

Thank you for your hard work at IMPACT! - Thank you on behalf of me and Tim for your hard work on the SE Design Workshops at Innovate Park at IMPACT! Nikki and Tim

07/17/19 - You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Jeff Sharritts, Benefit Everyone

Congratulations! - Congratulations on your recent CLUS Distinguished Speaker recognition, no small feat! Thank you for all the hard work you put into your session, I appreciate everything you do for our customers and our team. Gratefully, Jeff

07/13/19 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Brad Adams, Connect Everything

Architecture at UHG - Great job of escalating and driving the message about building integrations into our products as to help us transition to next generation, end-to-end architectures at UHG.

07/05/19 - You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Karen Walker, Connect Everything

CLUS - Thank you for your leadership throughout the year on shaping the Cisco Live content program. You went above and beyond! We could not have realized such amazing success without you, your energy and your passionate ideas. Congratulations! Karen, Kathy, Alex

03/22/19 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Barton Shaw, Connect Everything

Great Partnership - Brenden, thank you once again for all the time and energy you invest in supporting our efforts at State Farm. The security briefing you participated in was months in the making, and it took significant work to get so many directors architects and analysts to attend. Your engagement was spot on and very well received. Getting to Central Illinois is never easy, and you deserve this recognition.

02/04/19 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Jeff Erwin, Connect Everything

Cloud Integration Hub v2 - Thanks again for all the work on CIH / CE RFP preso and lab work. Meant to send higher \$ amount on first, hence the second recognition. Thanks again.

02/04/19 - You Inspire 2, \$50, Recognized by Jeff Erwin, Connect Everything

CIH Lab Work / Preso - Julian/BrB/Tom - Thanks so much for your work on CIH / Cloud Exchange. You all went above and beyond to work over the weekend and to create customized presentations / labs to meet the timeline requirements of UHG.

Connected Recognition 2018

12/22/18 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Scott Jost, Connect Everything

Territory Coverage with ACI, Tetration, and AppD - Thanks boys for all your work within our accounts over the past many months. Cummins, Humana, Kindred, Lilly, Anthem, State Farm and Caterpillar have all be big targets for us. you have been great delivering the message. we have a great roadmap to big success for the 2nd half of FY19. Thanks for your commitment.

12/05/18 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Phil Koontz, Benefit Everyone

Phenomenal Support - Brenden, Thanks so much for presenting Zero Trust Cloud Edge at the Johns Hopkins Tech Day. Your presentation was well received by Johns Hopkins and VERY much appreciated by the Account Team. Your presentation was very insightful and helped to wrap

Cisco Distinguished Architect Nomination - Brenden Buresh (bburesh)

Duo, OpenDNS SIG, and SAE all together. Also, thanks again for helping to drive the value of SAE with other Johns Hopkins entities. Looking forward to continuing to work with you and driving value for Johns Hopkins.

10/14/18 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Scott Jost, Innovate Everywhere

State Farm ACI RFP - Thanks David and Brenden for all your efforts with the State Farm RFP and EBC/Demo.

10/09/18 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Rachel Waters, Benefit Everyone

Connect Washington, DC - Thank you for presenting in our Data Center session for Connect DC!

08/02/18 - You Amaze 1, \$250, Recognized by Neil Harlock, Benefit Everyone

Outstanding Support for Customer CPOC - Brenden provided outstanding support for Progressive CPOC. Spending many weeks preparing and two weeks on site supporting the account team and customer. Brenden provided guidance and consultation to the customer to complete the CPOC test and leave them with confidence in deploying a Multisite ACI solution.

07/16/18 - You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Barton Shaw, Connect Everything

Fantastic job leading DFA/ACI Transition - On behalf of the State Farm account team, I'm pleased to send this recognition for all the work you've done with State Farm and with our team on building an architectural transition path from DFA to SDN / ACI. There was no way to prevent State Farm from issuing an RFP, and the ownership you've taken on our RFP response is truly appreciated. Please accept my sincere thanks. Barton

06/30/18 - You Amaze 2, \$500, Recognized by Karen Walker, Connect Everything

Cisco Live US - Thank you for your leadership throughout the year on shaping the Cisco Live content program. You went above and beyond! We could not have realized such amazing success without you, your energy and your passionate ideas. Congratulations! Karen

06/29/18 - You Inspire 3, \$100, Recognized by Jeff Erwin, Our People Deal

ACI and K8S - Brenden has been critical to our deployment of ACI at UHG. UHG is on the leading edge with K8s and ACI integration. Brenden has been critical to our success at UHG.

SALES RECOGNITION

Sales Achiever

2019 – Principal Systems Engineer
2018 – Principal Systems Engineer
2016 - Technical Solutions Architect
2013 - Technical Solutions Architect
2012 - Technical Solutions Architect
2011 – Technical Solutions Architect
2007 – Systems Engineer

Sales Champion

2014 - Technical Solutions Architect

CISCO LIVE DISTINGUISHED SPEAKER

CiscoLive Europe 2019
CiscoLive Australia 2015